Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board
Believing, Achieving, Serving

STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING COMMITTEE MEETING

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024

COMMITTEE MEMBERS

Mr. M. Valvasori, Chairperson
Mrs. E. Agostino
Mr. L. Agro
Mrs. J. Angelini
Mr. A. D'Intino
Mr. P. Homerski, Vice-Chairperson
Mr. P. J. Daly
Mrs. M. Nardini
Mr. J. Valvasori

STUDENT TRUSTEES

Miss. Carla Khalil
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Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board
Believing, Achieving, Serving

NOTICE OF MEETING
Student Achievement and Well-Being Committee – Tuesday, October 15, 2024

To: Student Achievement and Well-Being Committee
From: D. Hansen - Director of Education, M. Hucal - Superintendent of Education
Date: Friday, October 11, 2024

A meeting of the Student Achievement and Well-Being Committee of the Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board has been scheduled for **Tuesday, October 15, 2024.**

The meeting will begin at **immediately following Special Board meeting.**

Your attendance at this meeting would be greatly appreciated.



M. Hucal, Secretary



D. Hansen, Director of Education

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board
Believing, Achieving, Serving

SAWB-24-8

Immediately following Special Board meeting

October 15, 2024

STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING COMMITTEE

A G E N D A

1. Opening Prayer

   Dear Father in Heaven,

   We gather today with grateful hearts, seeking Your guidance and wisdom as we work to support the success and well-being of the students entrusted to our care. We ask that You bless our discussions and decisions, that they may be guided by Your love and compassion.

   Grant us the insight to see the unique gifts in each student, the courage to address their needs, and the creativity to find solutions that will help them thrive academically, emotionally, and spiritually. May our actions reflect Your teachings and bring light and hope to our school community.

   Help us to work together in unity, respecting and valuing each voice, so that our efforts may truly serve the needs of those we are called to support. We ask this in the name of Your Son, Jesus Christ, who showed us the way to love, serve, and uplift one another.

   Amen.

2. Noting of Members Present and Absent, Resolutions Excusing Absence

3. Approval of the Order of Business

4. Declaration of Interest

5. Motions to Receive, Motions of Referral Committee or Staff Communications, Petitions, and Delegations

6. **Presentation of Reports:**

a)	Graduation Rate – 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 Cohorts	1-20
b)	Education Quality and Accountability Office (EQAO) Assessment Results 2024	21-44
c)	Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board Mathematics Improvement Action Plan Update	45-54
d)	Healthy Schools Certification	55-68
e)	English As a Second Language and Newcomer Update: Elementary	69-90
f)	Suspension, Expulsion, Refusal of Access, and Violent Incident Report 2023/24	91-110

7. Notices of Motion

8. New Business - (A) Future Agenda Items 111

9. Closing Prayer and Adjournment

REPORT **SAWB-24-8**

TO: **STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING COMMITTEE**

SUBJECT: **GRADUATION RATE - 2018-2019 AND 2019-2020 COHORTS**

DATE: **TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024**

2024-25 BUDGET DRIVER ALIGNMENT

Excellence

ORIGIN

Director's Council

BACKGROUND

Graduation from secondary school in Ontario is dependent upon achieving a set of requirements specified by the Ministry of Education's Ontario Secondary School Diploma (OSSD). The Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board (HWCDSB) supports students as they work toward graduation through the framework of the Ontario Catholic School Graduate Expectations (OCSGEs) which are a set of distinctively Catholic subject and skill-oriented objectives that support the development of the whole person.

The graduation rate is the percentage of students who successfully achieved the requirements of the OSSD within a specified duration of time, in comparison to the initial number of students who entered Grade 9 as a cohort in the same school year. This measurement is used to monitor and assess the impact of instructional and support-based strategies on student success. In Ontario, graduation rates over both four and five years are calculated and published.

This report examines the graduation rates and related data for the cohort of students who entered Grade 9 in the 2018-2019 school year, as well as some of the graduation rates for the cohort of students who entered Grade 9 in the 2019-2020 school year.

COMMENT

Although the term graduation and the calculation of graduation rates only apply to the successful completion of the OSSD requirements, completion of secondary school in Ontario is also formally recognized through two alternative credentials: the Ontario Secondary School Certificate (OSSC) and the Certificate of Accomplishment.

Ontario Secondary School Diploma (OSSD)

There are two sets of graduation requirements applicable to students currently in secondary school. Each is dependent upon when a student began Grade 9.

Students who started Grade 9 in 2023 or in prior years are required to earn:

- 18 compulsory credits;
- 12 optional credits;

- at least 2 online learning credits;
- 40 hours of Christian Service; and,
- the Ontario Secondary School Literacy Test or the Ontario Literacy Course.

Students who started Grade 9 in 2024 or in later years are required to earn:

- 17 compulsory credits;
- 13 optional credits;
- at least 2 online learning credits;
- 40 hours of Christian Service; and,
- the Ontario Secondary School Literacy Test or the Ontario Literacy Course.

The Ministry of Education's graduation requirement for online learning necessitates that students who entered Grade 9 in the 2020-2021 school year or later must earn at least two online learning credits. Students in the 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 cohorts began secondary school prior to this date, and as such, did not have to meet this requirement.

Students from the 2018-2019 cohort who graduated in four years by 2021-2022 (August 2022), were subject to a modification of the Christian service and literacy requirements of the OSSD because of the COVID-19 pandemic. The Ministry of Education reduced the required Christian Service hours to 20 and eliminated the literacy graduation requirement. These OSSD requirements were reinstated to full for students who graduated in 2022-2023 or later. This includes the 2018-2019 cohort students who graduated in five years by August 2023, and the 2019-2020 cohort students who graduated in four years by August 2023 and in five years by August 2024.

A detailed breakdown of both sets of graduation requirements are available on the Ministry of Education website. To complement this, an HWCDSB Graduation Requirements summary sheet has been created and is provided in Appendix A of this report.

Ontario Secondary School Certificate (OSSC)

The OSSC will be granted, on request, to students leaving secondary school upon reaching the age of 18 without having met the requirements for the OSSD. To be granted an OSSC, a student must have earned at least 14 credits, including seven compulsory credits and seven optional credits.

Certificate of Accomplishment (C of A)

A Certificate of Accomplishment may be granted to students leaving secondary school upon reaching the age of 18 without having met the requirements for the OSSD or the OSSC. This designation recognizes achievement for students who plan to further specific training, or who plan to find employment directly after leaving school.

Graduation Rates

As per the Ministry of Education and for the purpose of this report, graduation rate is defined as the number of students who earned an OSSD divided by the total number in the Grade 9 cohort. The graduation rate in Ontario is calculated for both four-year and five-year graduates.

The Ministry published board graduation rates include students registered with the HWCDSB in Grade 9 and stayed in the HWCDSB until graduation, as well as the students who moved to another school board. This cohorting methodology ensures that graduation rates are calculated with consistency for all school boards, and that all students who entered an Ontario school in Grade 9 are captured in the provincial data.

The HWCDSB's graduation rates include students who enrolled in Grade 9 at any time during that Grade 9 academic year and remained and graduated with the HWCDSB. These calculations do not include students who left the Board.

Provincial four-year and five-year graduation rates represent the average of all Ministry published board rates throughout the province.

Appendix B outlines the Ministry of Education and the HWCDSB formulas used to calculate graduation rates, over both four and five years.

2018-2019 and 2019-2020 Cohort Years

The following charts provide the grade level and accompanying school years for the 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 cohorts.

2018-2019 Cohort		
Year	**School Year**	**Grade Level**
1	2018-2019	Grade 9
2	2019-2020	Grade 10
3	2020-2021	Grade 11
4	2021-2022	Grade 12
5	2022-2023	Grade 12+

2019-2020 Cohort		
Year	**School Year**	**Grade Level**
1	2019-2020	Grade 9
2	2020-2021	Grade 10
3	2021-2022	Grade 11
4	2022-2023	Grade 12
5	2023-2024	Grade 12+

Students in the 2018-2019 cohort graduated in four years by August 2022 (2021-2022), and in five years by August 2023 (2022-2023). Students in the 2019-2020 cohort graduated in four years by August 2023 (2022-2023), and in five years by August 2024 (2023-2024).

COVID-19 Pandemic Impact on the Learning Conditions

Learning conditions were significantly impacted for both the 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 cohorts due to the COVID-19 pandemic. Schools closed to in-person learning during the 2018-2019 cohort's Grade 10 year, and the 2019-2020 cohort's Grade 9 year. Throughout the two school years that followed, students in these cohorts experienced disruptions to in-person learning, as well as periods of altered learning schedules and modalities (e.g., quadmesters and hybrid instruction).

Student success and well-being is supported by the HWCDSB through consistent dedication to academic excellence and faith formation. The provision of targeted activities, events, and interventions support students as they work toward graduation.

Transition from Grade 8 to Grade 9

Grade 8 to Grade 9 transition initiatives increase student preparedness to ensure a smooth transition for students moving from elementary to secondary school. The HWCDSB offers a carefully planned sequence of transition focused activities, including:

- teacher-supported self-reflection and planning for Grades 7 and 8 students through the completion of Individual Pathways Plan (IPP) requirements on myBlueprint;
- communication through the HWCDSB website, myClass, Board and school social media accounts, Grade 9 handbooks, and messages to parents/guardians;
- Grade 8 Parent Information Nights hosted at each Catholic secondary school;
- guidance department visits to support course selection in Grade 8 classes;
- Grade 8 class visits to secondary schools;
- pathways focused elementary outreach initiatives and experiential learning conducted by secondary schools;
- additional transition programs specifically designed for students with special education needs;
- the Passport to Grade 9 summer program; and,
- Grade 9 secondary school orientation days.

Professional Learning

In an ongoing manner, HWCDSB teachers are provided with a variety of professional learning opportunities that focus on achievement, pathways planning, and well-being. Equipping staff with current data and information in these key areas ensures they have the knowledge and tools required to best promote student success as students work toward graduation.

Professional Activity (PA) days are one method by which teachers have an opportunity to engage in professional learning, either by schools or departments/subject areas. The learning on these days often focuses on curriculum, programming, and reviewing student achievement data and to help build each school's Student Achievement Plan. In addition, teachers are provided with opportunities to participate in various symposiums, conferences, and experiential learning events throughout the school year that promote an increased understanding of student engagement and pathways planning.

School Student Success Teams

School student success teams collaborate to support students who are in risk and/or at risk of not graduating. Composed of school administration, student success teachers, guidance counsellors and special education resource teachers, these teams work to ensure that protective factors are made available for each student. Factors include provision of caring adult(s) (mentors/advocates), individualized timetabling, student profile (strengths and needs-based) development and a focus on individualized pathways planning (IPP) for the student's education/career life journey. School student success

teams actively track and monitor student progress, providing responsive and adaptive support.

Student Success Initiatives
Student success initiatives are designed to meet the needs, interests, and strengths of all students, engaging them in learning and in preparation for graduation and beyond. These highly effective, student-focused strategies include, but are not limited to:

- the Specialist High Skills Major (SHSM) program;
- the Ontario Youth Apprenticeship Program (OYAP);
- the Early College Graduation Program (ECGP);
- dual credit programs offered in collaboration with local colleges;
- cooperative (co-op) education courses;
- credit rescue;
- credit recovery;
- tutoring;
- Prior Learning Assessment and Recognition (PLAR);
- Supervised Alternative Learning (SAL);
- summer school and night school courses and programs;
- transition from Grade 8 to 9, and to post-secondary, initiatives; and,
- St. Charles Adult and Continuing Education alternative education and programming.

Re-engagement Opportunities
Students in Grade 12 or 12+ that have not graduated with an OSSD or have left school early are actively tracked by HWCDSB secondary schools. Student success teams endeavor to re-engage these students through development and implementation of a personalized re-engagement plan. Plans contain a curated collection of strategies and programs to help students successfully achieve credits as they work toward graduation.

Data Source:
Data provided in the appendices of this report is derived from the HWCDSB Ontario School Information System (OnSIS) database and Ministry of Education published rate resources.

Appendix C presents a comparison of the 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 four-year graduation rates with the previous four cohort years.

Appendix D presents a comparison of the 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 five-year graduations rates with the previous four cohort years. The Ministry published a five-year board graduation rate and provincial graduation rate for the 2019-2020 cohort is not included in the comparison as these rates are not yet available.

Appendix E presents a comparison of the 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 HWCDSB four-year and five-year graduation rates with the previous four cohort years, for students with an IEP. The Ministry of Education does not publish graduation rate data with respect to students with an IEP.

Appendix F presents the credit distribution data for the 2018-2019 cohort.

Key Findings:

Appendix C: Four-Year Graduation Rate Comparison
Appendix C compares the HWCDSB four-year graduation rate, the Ministry published board four-year graduation rate, and the provincial four-year graduation rates over six cohort years.

For the 2018-2019 cohort, the HWCDSB four-year graduation rate is 86%. This is 2% higher than the Ministry published board rate of 84% and is 1% higher than the provincial rate of 85%.

For the 2019-2020 cohort, the HWCDSB four-year graduation rate is 82%. This is identical to the Ministry published board rate of 82% and is 2% lower than the provincial rate of 84%.

Examination of the HWCDSB and Ministry published board four-year graduation rates over time reveals that these rates remained at or above 80% over the six cohort years and have been consistently close to the provincial rates (within 3%).

Appendix D: Five-Year Graduation Rate Comparison
Appendix D compares the HWCDSB five-year graduation rate, the Ministry published board five-year graduation rate, and the provincial five-year graduation rates over six cohort years, with the exclusion of the Ministry published board and provincial rate for the 2019-2020 cohort.

For the 2018-2019 cohort, the HWCDSB five-year graduation rate is 90%. This is identical to the Ministry published board rate of 90% and is also identical to the provincial rate of 90%.

For the 2019-2020 cohort, the HWCDSB five-year graduation rate is 90%. The Ministry published board rate and provincial rate are not yet available for comparison.

Examination of the HWCDSB and Ministry published board five-year graduation rates over time reveals that the rates have remained at or above 86% over the six cohort years and have consistently been close to the provincial rates (within 3%).

Appendix E: Four-Year and Five-Year HWCDSB Graduation Rates for Students with an Individual Education Plan (IEP)
Appendix E examines the HWCDSB's four-year and five-year graduation rates for students with an IEP. This includes students with exceptional and non-exceptional IEPs. As with the overall HWCDSB calculated graduation rates, these rates only include students who started Grade 9 with the HWCDSB and stayed in the Board.

The HWCDSB four-year graduation rate for students with an IEP has demonstrated relative consistency over time, fluctuating no more than 3% over the six cohort years examined. During this period, the average four-year rate of graduation was 74%.

The HWCDSB five-year graduation rate for students with an IEP has also demonstrated relative consistency over time, fluctuating no more than 4% over the six cohort years examined. During this period, the average five-year rate of graduation was 83%.

Appendix F: Credit Distribution for Non-Graduates who Stayed in the HWCDSB for the 2018-2019 Cohort

Appendix F provides the credit distribution for HWCDSB students who did not graduate by the end of Year 5. This includes non-graduates still enrolled in Year 5, and early school leavers.

Of the non-graduates still enrolled in Year 5, 53% students had 20 or fewer credits. Of the early school leavers, 54% students had 20 or fewer credits.

Next Steps:

To encourage, engage, and support students as they work toward graduation, the HWCDSB will continue to provide learning supports, experiential learning opportunities, personalized pathways planning, job skills programs, and grade level/post-secondary transition initiatives to all students.

Secondary school teachers and administration will continue to examine credit accumulation data by the end of Grade 10 and at the beginning of Grade 12 for all students. These critical markers are projectors of success, as students who have not successfully completed 16 or more credits by the end of Grade 10 and/or 24 or more credits by the start of their Grade 12 school year are in a credit deficit and at-risk of not graduating. To support these students in achieving the missing credits and working toward the OSSD, school student success teams will continue to utilize targeted, student-focused strategies.

RECOMMENDATION

THAT THE REPORT, GRADUATION RATE – 2018-2019 AND 2019-2020 COHORTS, DATED TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024, BE RECEIVED.

PREPARED BY: S. BEREZIUK
STUDENT SUCCESS CONSULTANT

SUBMITTED BY: D. DIFRANCESCO
SUPERINTENDENT OF EDUCATION

D. HANSEN
DIRECTOR OF EDUCATION

APPENDIX A

For students who started **Grade 9 in 2023 or earlier**

Graduation Requirements

OSSD Ontario Secondary School Diploma

HWCDSB

30 CREDITS IN TOTAL + **40** HOURS OF CHRISTIAN SERVICE + LITERACY REQUIREMENT + **2** ONLINE LEARNING CREDITS

Students must earn the following credits to obtain the Ontario Secondary School Diploma:

Religious Education Credits	Credits
Religious Education (1 per grade)	4
Compulsory Credits	**Credits**
English (1 per grade)	4
mathematics (at least 1 in Grade 11 or 12)	3
Science	2
Canadian history (Grade 10)	1
Canadian geography (Grade 9)	1
the arts	1
health and physical education	1
French as a second language	1
career studies	0.5
civics and citizenship	0.5
compulsory course group 1	1
compulsory course group 2	1
compulsory course group 3	1
Optional Credits	**Credits**
✓ optional credits from the secondary school's program and course calendar	8

Including ONE credit from each of the following compulsory course groups:

Compulsory Course Groups

Group 1
- Grade 11 Religious Education
- English (including OSSLC) or French as a second language
- Native languages
- First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Studies
- classical and international languages
- social sciences and the humanities
- Canadian and world studies
- guidance and career education
- cooperative education

Group 2
- health and physical education
- the arts
- business studies
- French as a second language
- cooperative education

Group 3
- science (Grade 11 or 12)
- technological education
- French as a second language
- computer studies
- cooperative education

Other Requirements

- ✓ 40 hours of Christian Service volunteering activities, which can start the summer before Grade 9
- ✓ the provincial literacy requirement: OSSLT or OSSLC
- ✓ at least 2 credits of online learning (opt out available)

Students are expected to take a Religious Education course each year, in Grades 9-12. A maximum of 3 credits in English as a second language (ESL) or English Literacy Development (ELD) can be used towards the 4 compulsory credits in English, but the fourth credit must be a Grade 12 compulsory English course. In groups 1, 2, and 3, students can count a maximum of 2 credits in French as a second language as compulsory credits, 1 from group 1 and 1 from either group 2 or group 3. A maximum of 2 credits in cooperative education may be counted as compulsory credits. Optional credits may include up to 4 credits achieved through dual credit programs.

For students who started **Grade 9 in 2024 and after**

Graduation Requirements

OSSD Ontario Secondary School Diploma

30 CREDITS IN TOTAL + **40** HOURS OF CHRISTIAN SERVICE + LITERACY REQUIREMENT + **2** ONLINE LEARNING CREDITS + FINANCIAL LITERACY REQUIREMENT

Students must earn the following credits to obtain the Ontario Secondary School Diploma:

Religious Education Credits	Credits
Religious Education (1 per grade)	4
Compulsory Credits	**Credits**
English (1 per grade)	4
mathematics (Grade 9, 10, and 11 or 12)	3
science	2
technological education (Grade 9 or 10)	1
Canadian history (Grade 10)	1
Canadian geography (Grade 9)	1
the arts	1
health and physical education	1
French as a second language	1
career studies	0.5
civics and citizenship	0.5
STEM-related course group	1
Optional Credits	**Credits**
✓ optional credits from the secondary school's program and course calendar	9

Including ONE credit from the following STEM-related course group:

STEM-related Course Group
• business studies • computer studies • cooperative education • mathematics (in addition to the 3 compulsory credits currently required) • science (in addition to the 2 compulsory credits currently required) • technological education (in addition to the 1 compulsory credit required)



Other Requirements
✓ 40 hours of Christian Service volunteering activities, which can start the summer before Grade 9
✓ the provincial literacy requirement: OSSLT or OSSLC
✓ at least 2 credits of online learning (opt out available)
✓ starting in 2025, students must earn a new financial literacy graduation requirement as part of the compulsory Grade 10 mathematics course, and must achieve a mark of 70% or higher to pass this requirement

Students are expected to take a Religious Education course each year, in Grades 9-12. A maximum of 3 credits in English as a second language (ESL) or English Literacy Development (ELD) can be used towards the 4 compulsory credits in English, but the fourth credit must be a Grade 12 compulsory English course. Optional credits may include up to 4 credits achieved through dual credit programs.

APPENDIX B

Graduation Rate Calculations: Ministry Published Board Rates

The Ministry of Education calculates graduation rate as the percentage of students who successfully achieved the OSSD within a specified duration of time, in comparison to the initial number of students who entered Grade 9 as a cohort in the same school year.

The Grade 9 cohort is defined by the following parameters:

- students who are between 13 and 15 years old as of December 31st;
- Grade 9 students only;
- students who are registered for the first time in a secondary school in Ontario;
- students who are enrolled at any time during the Grade 9 academic year and did not become deceased or leave Ontario before the end of Grade 12; and,
- students who are enrolled at publicly funded day schools in public and Roman Catholic school boards.

The Ministry of Education publicly reports both four-year and five-year graduation rates. Ministry published board graduation rates are calculated as follows:

$$\textbf{Board Four-Year Graduation Rate} = \frac{\begin{array}{c}\text{Graduates that stayed in same board (Year 1-4)*} \\ \text{+ Graduates within 4 years and moved to another board}\end{array}}{\begin{array}{c}\text{Cohort stayed in same board} \\ \text{+ Cohort moved to another board} \\ \text{- Students deceased or left Ontario}\end{array}}$$

$$\textbf{Board Five-Year Graduation Rate} = \frac{\begin{array}{c}\text{Graduates that stayed in same board (Year 1-5)*} \\ \text{+ Graduates within 5 years and moved to another board}\end{array}}{\begin{array}{c}\text{Cohort stayed in same board} \\ \text{+ Cohort moved to another board} \\ \text{- Students deceased or left Ontario}\end{array}}$$

*Students in the Grade 9 cohort must have their earliest entry into an Ontario secondary school on one of the Board's three OnSIS count dates (October 31, March 31, or June 30).

Graduation Rate Calculations: HWCDSB Rates

The HWCDSB calculates four-year and five-year graduation rates based on the number of students who enrolled in Grade 9 at any time during the Grade 9 academic year, and remained and graduated with the HWCDSB. These calculations do not include students who have left the Board.

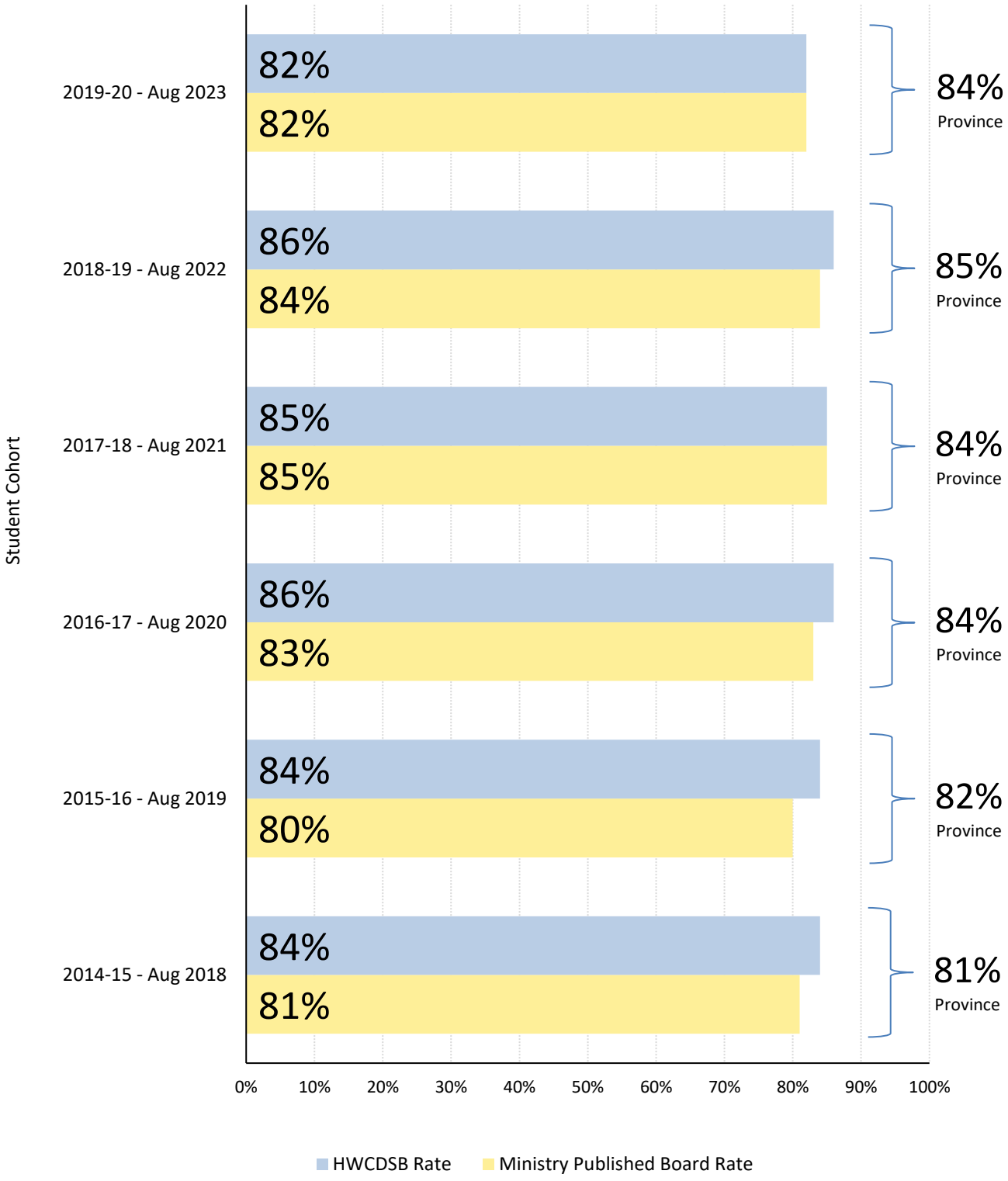
HWCDSB graduation rates are calculated as follows:

$$\textbf{HWCDSB Four-Year Graduation Rate} = \frac{\text{Graduates that stayed in HWCDSB (Year 1-4)}}{\text{Cohort stayed in HWCDSB}}$$

$$\textbf{HWCDSB Five-Year Graduation Rate} = \frac{\text{Graduates that stayed in HWCDSB (Year 1-5)}}{\text{Cohort stayed in HWCDSB}}$$

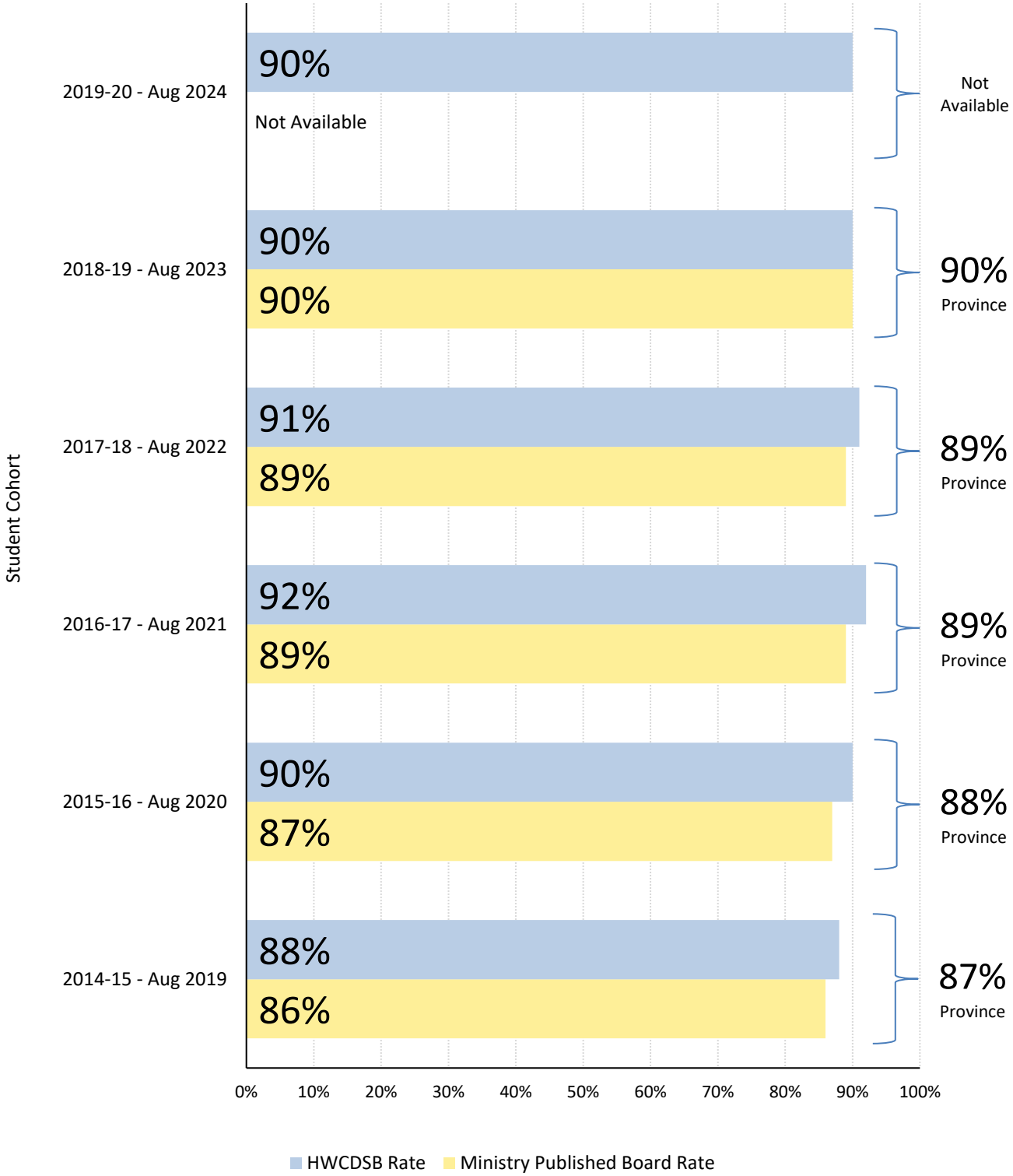
APPENDIX C

Four-Year Graduation Rate Comparison



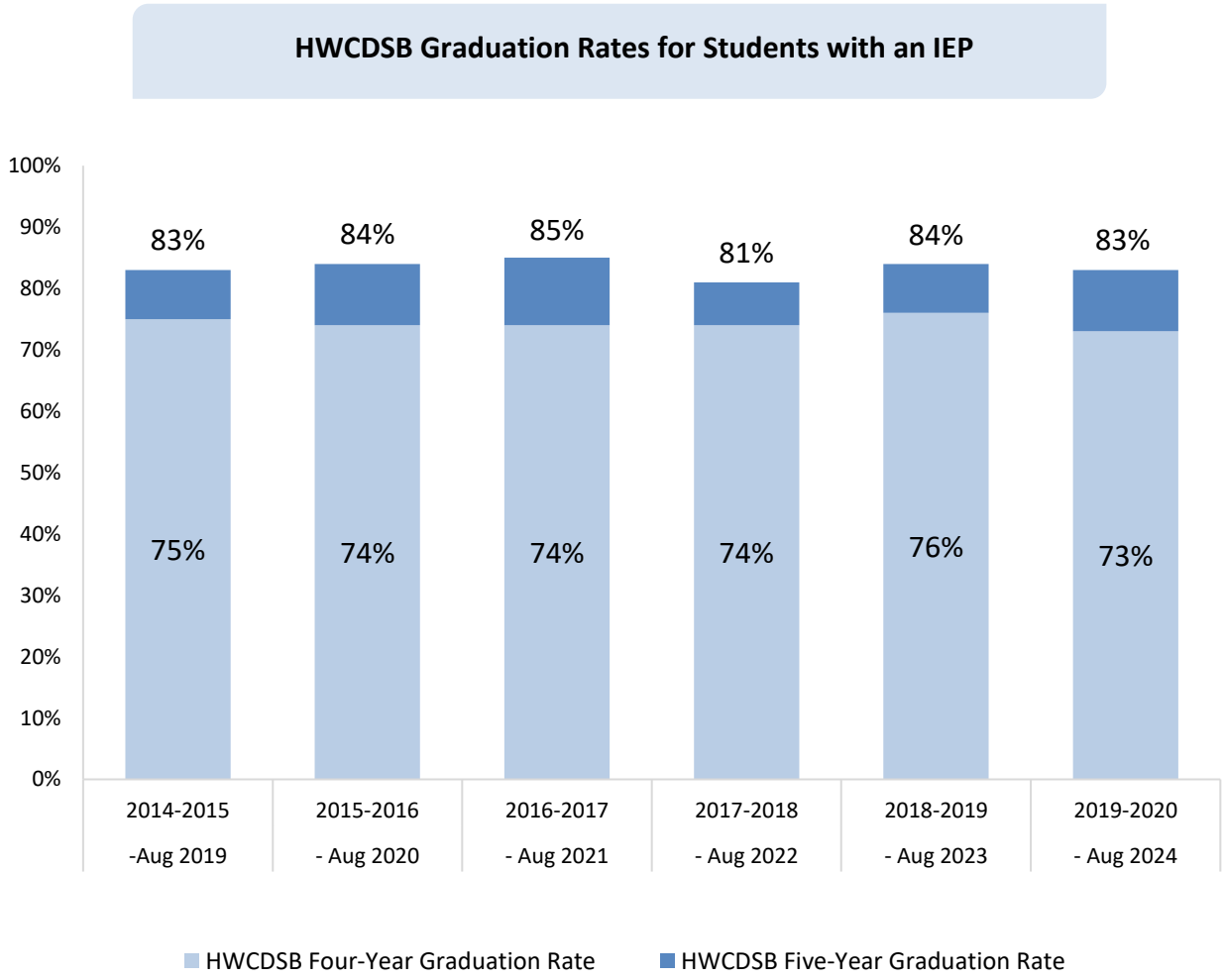
APPENDIX D

Five-Year Graduation Rate Comparison



APPENDIX E

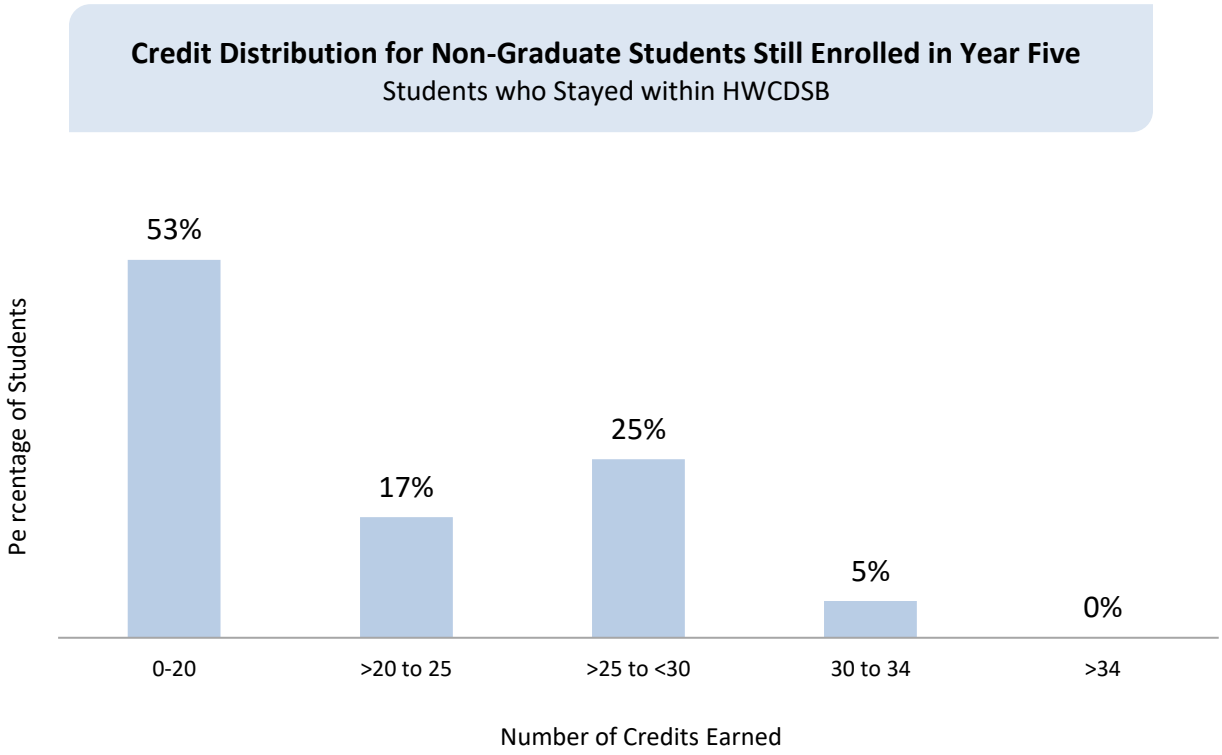
Four-Year and Five-Year HWCDSB Graduation Rates for Students with an IEP

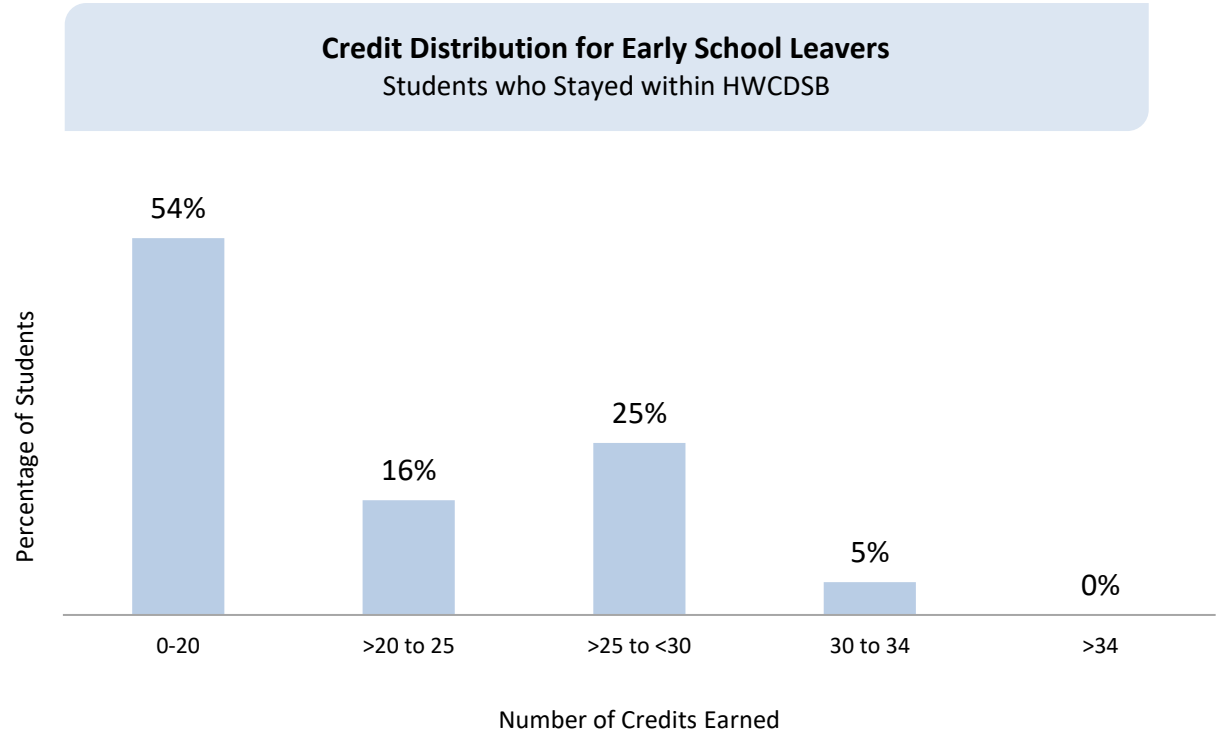


Note: Data includes students working toward an OSSD who have an IEP (exceptional and non-exceptional) anytime from end of Grade 9.

APPENDIX F

Credit Distribution for Non-Graduates who Stayed in the HWCDSB for the 2018-2019 Cohort





REPORT **SAWB-24-8**

TO: STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING COMMITTEE

SUBJECT: EDUCATION QUALITY AND ACCOUNTABILITY OFFICE (EQAO) ASSESSMENT RESULTS 2024

DATE: TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024

2024-25 BUDGET DRIVER ALIGNMENT
Excellence

ORIGIN

Director's Council

BACKGROUND

This report presents an overview of the 2023-2024 results for the Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board (HWCDSB) based on the assessments conducted by the Education Quality and Accountability Office (EQAO) at various grade levels across the province.

The report summarizes the results of the Assessments of Reading, Writing, and Mathematics for the Primary Division (Grades 1–3) and Junior Division (Grades 4–6), as well as for Grade 9 Mathematics and the Grade 10 Ontario Secondary School Literacy Test (OSSLT). It captures the achievements of students who fully participated in the 2023-2024 EQAO assessments.

Data from these assessments serve as a catalyst for improvement at the individual student, school, and school board levels. School improvement teams utilize this data alongside other indicators of student achievement (e.g., report card grades, classroom assessment results, attendance) to create a comprehensive profile of student skills, abilities, work habits, and knowledge.

This report provides a summary of the 2023-2024 EQAO results for:

- Grade 3 Assessment of Reading, Writing, and Mathematics, Primary Division;
- Grade 6 Assessment of Reading, Writing, and Mathematics, Junior Division;
- Grade 9 Assessment of Mathematics; and,
- Grade 10 OSSLT Fully Participating First Time Eligible (FTE).

COMMENT

EQAO is reporting for the third year on the student achievement results of its digitalized and modernized provincial assessments. The primary and junior assessments were administered in all HWCDSB elementary schools between May 2024 and June 2024.

Grade 3 and 6 Assessment of Reading and Writing
These assessments are designed to measure the reading and writing skills students are expected to have learned by the end of Grade 3 and Grade 6.

Grade 3 and 6 Assessment of Mathematics
This is a multi-stage, computer-adaptive, linear-designed test conducted on a computer, aimed at assessing the knowledge and skills students are expected to have learned by the end of Grade 3 and Grade 6.

Grade 9 Assessment of Mathematics
This assessment was administered in all HWCDSB secondary schools at the end of each semester, first in January 2024 and again in June 2024. Every student taking Grade 9 de-streamed Mathematics (MTH 1W1) was required to participate. The test represents 10% of each student's final grade and is included as part of the culminating assessment. This assessment is also a multi-stage, computer-adaptive, linear test conducted on a computer.

Grade 10 Ontario Secondary School Literacy Test (OSSLT)
The OSSLT is a computer-based assessment that measures whether students are meeting the minimum standard for literacy across all subjects up to the end of Grade 9. Successful completion of the OSSLT is a requirement to earn an Ontario Secondary School Diploma.

Data Sources
The results of EQAO assessments for any school year are published in the fall of the following year. Results are published by school, school board, and provincial average. All data in this report is publicly available. The data below and more can be accessed at Provincial results (eqao.com).

Key Findings:

The results of the EQAO assessments are contained in the tables below. Graphs for many of these results can be found in the appendices:

- Appendix A summarizes participation rates;
- Appendix B summarizes overall results on each of the assessments;
- Appendix C summarizes results for students with special education needs;
- Appendix D summarizes the Grade 3 and 6 results for reading, writing and mathematics at equal opportunities schools; and,
- Appendix E summarizes results by gender.

EQAO Results for Reading and Writing, Primary and Junior Divisions
The HWCDSB participation rate for students in Grade 3 is 94.3% and Grade 6 is 95.9%. The following are highlights from the Grade 3 and Grade 6 assessments:

Assessment	Province	HWCDSB students at or above provincial standard	HWCDSB change from 2022-23
Grade 3 Reading	71.2%	79.7%	↑ 1.6%
Grade 3 Writing	63.7%	75.5%	↑ 2.8%
Grade 6 Reading	82.0%	82.9%	↓ 1.9%
Grade 6 Writing	80.4%	81.9%	↓ 3.9%

Equal Opportunities Results in Reading and Writing, Primary and Junior Divisions
The results below capture the achievement levels of students at the eight elementary Equal Opportunities schools:

Assessment	Province	HWCDSB students at or above provincial standard	HWCDSB change from 2022-23
Grade 3 Reading	71.2%*	70.1%	↑ 6.4%
Grade 3 Writing	63.7%*	63.9%	↑ 7.3%
Grade 6 Reading	82.0%*	75.7%	↑ 4.5%
Grade 6 Writing	80.4%*	72.8%	↓ 0.5%

* The provincial average in the table above is the general average of any school in Ontario, as “equal opportunities” is an HWCDSB term, with no provincial comparator.

Students with Special Education Needs in Reading and Writing, Primary and Junior Divisions
The results outlined below capture the achievement levels of students with special education needs (excluding gifted):

Assessment	Province	HWCDSB students at or above provincial standard	HWCDSB change from 2022-23
Grade 3 Reading	45.1%	52.3%	↑ 1.2%
Grade 3 Writing	37.6%	49.1%	↑ 7.5%
Grade 6 Reading	58.9%	59.4%	↑ 1.0%
Grade 6 Writing	55.0%	56.8%	↓ 2.1%

Results by Gender in Reading and Writing, Primary and Junior
The results outlined below capture gender specific achievement levels of participating students:

Assessment	Female students at or above the provincial standard		Male students at or above the provincial standard	
	Province	HWCDSB	Province	HWCDSB
Grade 3 Reading	74.8%	84.5%	67.8%	75.2%
Grade 3 Writing	69.6%	81.0%	58.1%	70.2%
Grade 6 Reading	85.5%	85.8%	78.6%	80.3%
Grade 6 Writing	85.7%	87.3%	75.4%	76.8%

EQAO Results Summary for the OSSLT (Grade 10)

The HWCDSB participation rate for fully participating first-time eligible (FTE) students is 89.3%, which is 3.1% below the provincial average rate. Student achievement levels for fully participating FTE students are below:

Ontario Secondary School Literacy Test (Grade 10)			
Student Group	Province	HWCDSB successful students	HWCDSB change from 2022-23
All	84.5%	81.4%	↑ 4.9%
Female	86.9%	84.8%	↑ 4.1%
Male	82.2%	78.1%	↑ 5.6%
Academic	90.1%	88.6%	↑ 2.2%
Applied	58.2%	39.9%	↑ 2.7%
Students with Special Education Needs (excluding gifted)	66.2%	54.8%	↑ 6.7%

EQAO Mathematics Assessment Results in Mathematics, Primary and Junior Divisions

The HWCDSB participation rate for students in Grade 3 is 94.4% and Grade 6 is 95.8%. The following are highlights from the Grade 3 and Grade 6 assessment:

Assessment	Province	HWCDSB students at or above provincial standard	HWCDSB change from 2022-23
Grade 3 Mathematics	61.3%	71.6%	↑ 7.1%
Grade 6 Mathematics	50.2%	51.2%	↑ 3.1%

Equal Opportunities Results in Mathematics, Primary and Junior Divisions

The results below capture how our eight Equal Opportunities schools achieved relative to the HWCDSB and provincial results:

Assessment	Province	HWCDSB (All Schools)	HWCDSB Equal Opportunities	Equal Opportunities change from 2022-23
Grade 3 Mathematics	61.3%*	71.6%	57.4%	↑ 7.4%
Grade 6 Mathematics	50.2%*	51.2%	36.6%	↑ 7.8%

*The provincial average in the table above is the general average of any school in Ontario, as “equal opportunities” is a HWCDSB term, with no provincial comparator.

Students with Special Education Needs in Mathematics, Primary and Junior Divisions

The results outlined below capture the achievement of students with special education needs (excluding gifted):

Assessment	Province	HWCDSB students at or above provincial standard	HWCDSB change from 2022-23
Grade 3 Mathematics	31.0%	42.7%	↑ 11.2%
Grade 6 Mathematics	31.3%	22.7%	↑ 5.3%

Results by Gender in Mathematics, Primary and Junior Divisions

The results outlined below capture gender specific achievement of participating students:

Assessment	Female students at or above the provincial standard		Male students at or above the provincial standard	
	Province	HWCDSB	Province	HWCDSB
Grade 3 Mathematics	57.9%	68.5%	64.6%	74.5%
Grade 6 Mathematics	46.6%	47.1%	53.7%	55.1%

EQAO Results for the Assessment of Mathematics, Grade 9

The HWCDSB participation rate for students is 91.4%, which is 1.8% above the provincial rate. The following are highlights from the Grade 9 Assessment of Mathematics:

Student Group	Province	HWCDSB successful students	HWCDSB change from 2022-23
All	53.9%	55.3%	↑ 4.9%
Female	51.7%	52.5%	↑ 2.8%
Male	56.0%	57.9%	↑ 6.8%
Students with Special Education Needs (excluding gifted)	35.7%	33.2%	↑8.4%

Next Steps:

In response to the EQAO literacy data shared in this report, the following actions are planned for the 2024-2025 school year:

- School principals have received EQAO and early reading screening data to support the development of school achievement plans focusing on evidence-based and responsive instruction;
- Curriculum teams will continue to support educators in evidence-based literacy instruction within the context of differentiated and responsive teaching;
- Curriculum teams will continue to support the implementation of the Language 2023 curriculum, including the cross-panel focus on foundational reading and writing skills;
- Literacy Resource Teachers (LRTs) will continue to address gap closing and student achievement based on early reading screening data;

- Explore literacy resources in junior and intermediate grades to address gap closing and student achievement;
- A successful pilot project was conducted at Bishop Ryan Catholic Secondary School in 2023-24, where the OSSLT was written by the entire student cohort in one dedicated morning session. Other schools will adopt this practice in 2024-25. This efficient administration will provide school staff with more time to focus on future intervention and remediation strategies; and,
- The Secondary School System Literacy Committee will collaborate on ways to provide school-specific intervention and support for students writing the OSSLT.

In response to the EQAO mathematics data shared in this report, the following actions are planned for the 2024-2025 school year:

- Continue the 2023-2024 practice of providing centrally prepared EQAO preparation materials to all schools. These materials emphasize the importance of having students show their thinking on paper before deciding on a response;
- Continue the 2023-2024 practice of facilitating classroom visits for all classes by a member of the central mathematics curriculum team;
- The following schools have been identified as priority schools that will receive weekly small group, student-level support from one of our six teacher mathematics facilitators. Grade 6 priority classes were identified using 2021-22 EQAO data, and Grade 3 classes were identified based on historical results and trends:

Annunciation of Our Lord CES	St. Eugene CES	St. Margaret Mary CES
Holy Name of Jesus CES	St. Francis Xavier CES	St. Marguerite D'Youville CES
Our Lady of Lourdes CES	St. John the Baptist CES	St. Matthew CES
St. Agnes CES	St. Kateri Tekakwitha CES	St. Michael CES
St. Ann (Hamilton) CES	St. Lawrence CES	St. Patrick CES
St. David CES	St. Luke CES	Sts. Peter and Paul CES

- Non-priority schools will receive central support from the elementary numeracy consultant and other members of the mathematics team;
- Conduct a survey seeking input from 2023-2024 Grades 3 and 6 teachers on the effectiveness of the various initiatives;
- Provide gap-closing mathematics resources to Grades 7 and 8 students;
- Implement a revamped central resource for the Grade 9 Gap-Closing Mathematics course (GLE 1OM), including professional development for teachers of this course; and,
- Provide school-level professional development to support increased resource implementation, promote the use of digital mathematics tools, and build a positive mathematics culture focused on high achievement.

RECOMMENDATION

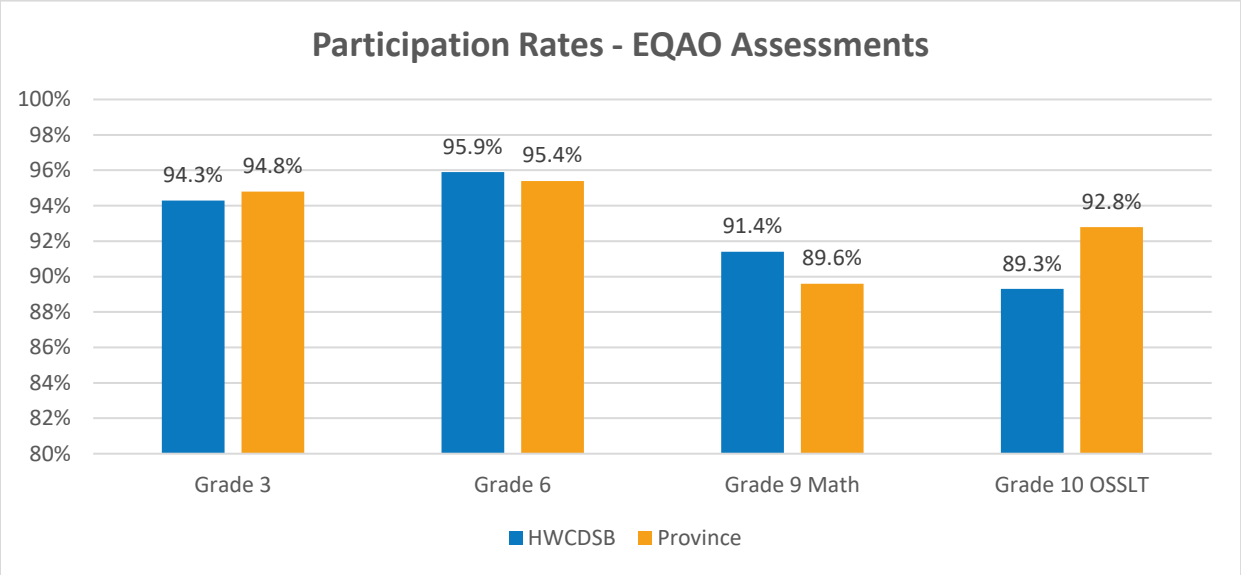
THAT THE REPORT, EDUCATION QUALITY AND ACCOUNTABILITY OFFICE (EQAO) ASSESSMENT RESULTS 2024, DATED TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024, BE RECEIVED.

SUBMITTED BY: B. DALY
ASSISTANT SUPERINTENDENT OF EDUCATION

D. HANSEN
DIRECTOR OF EDUCATION

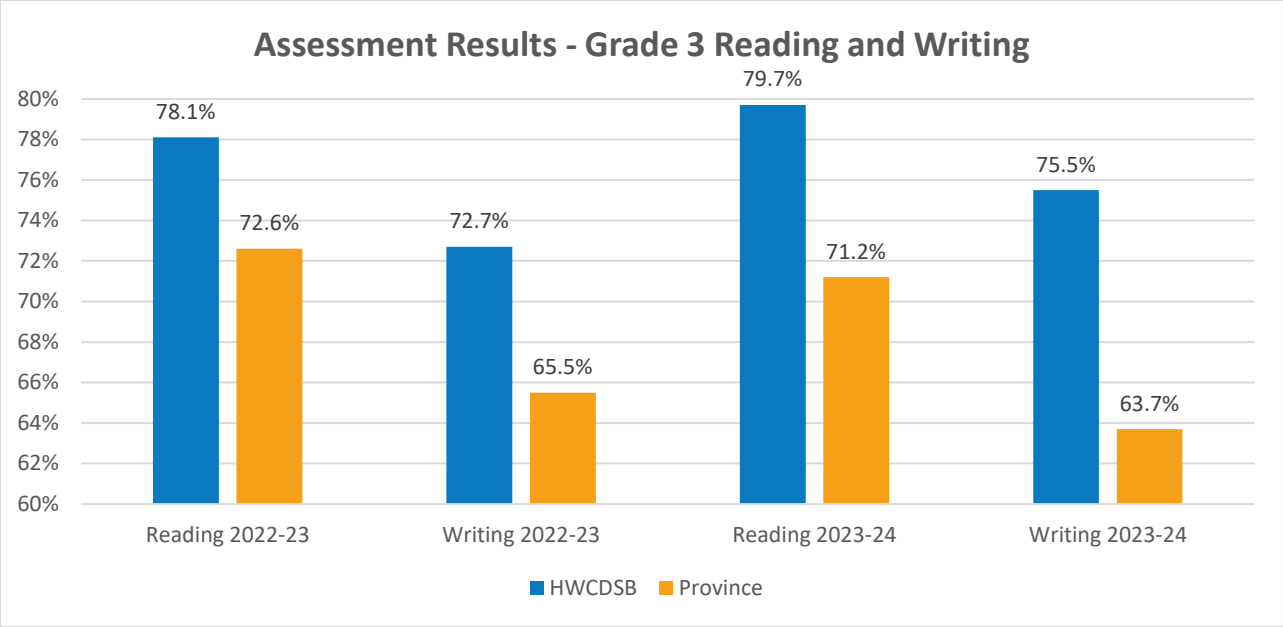
APPENDIX A

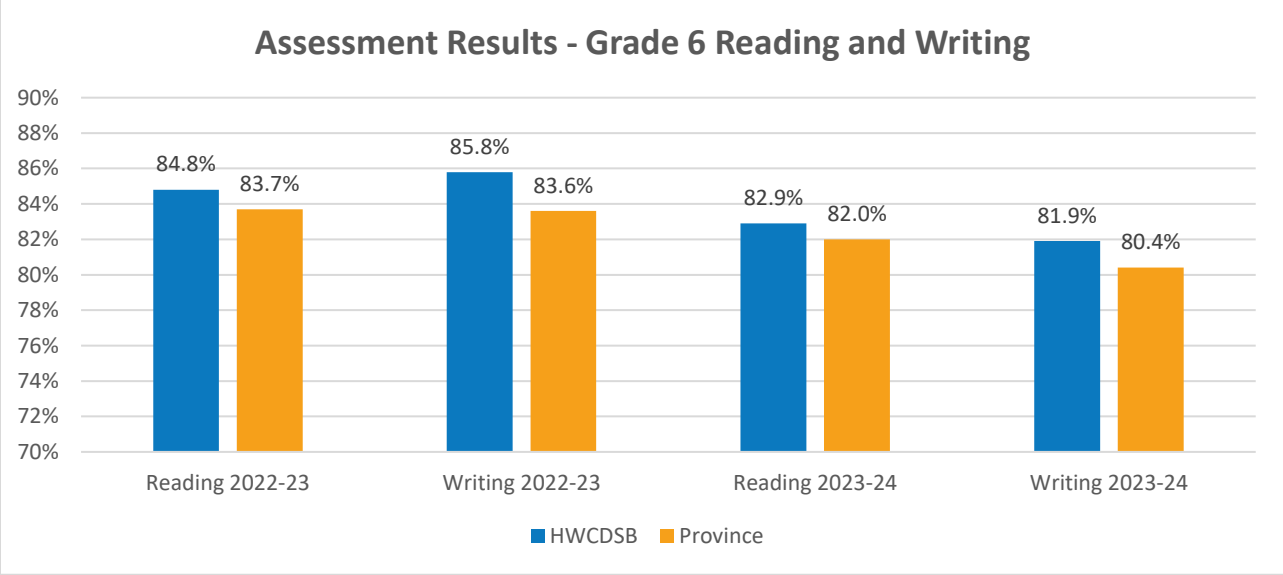
EQAO PARTICIPATION RATES ON GRADE 3, 6, 9, and OSSLT

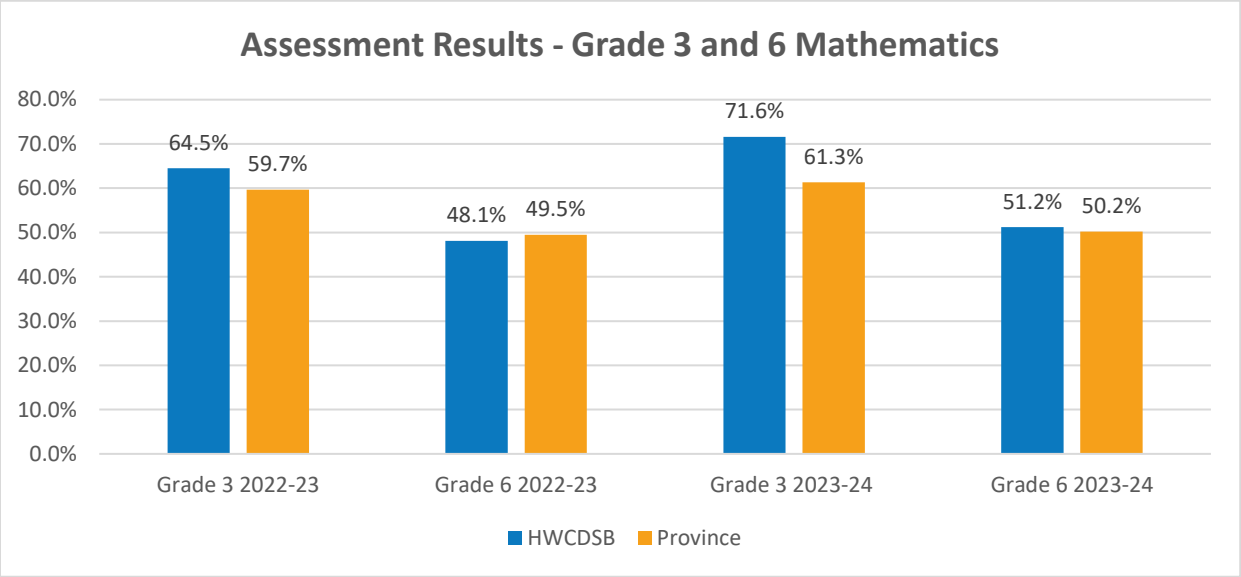


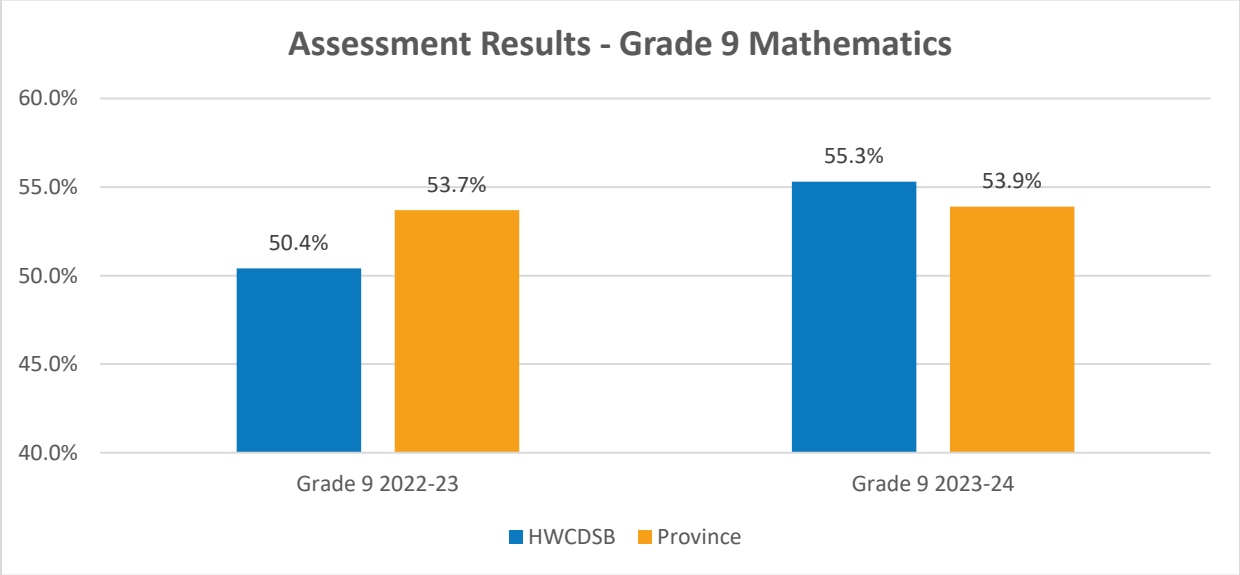
APPENDIX B

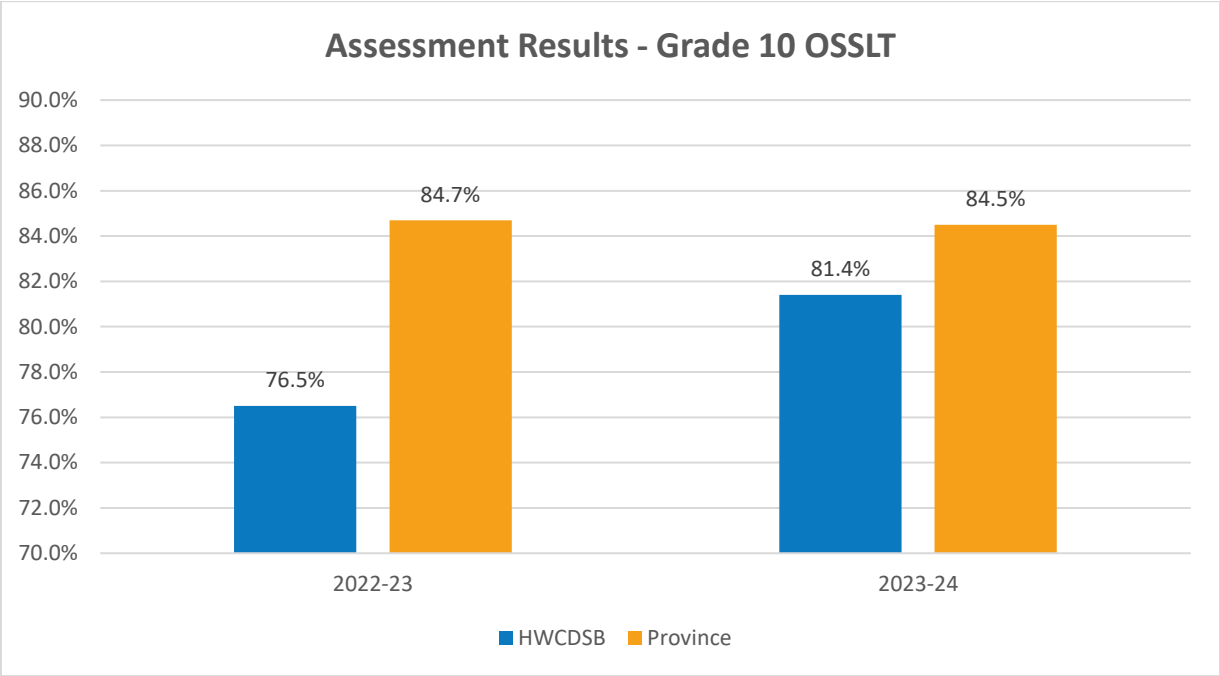
EQAO OVERALL RESULTS





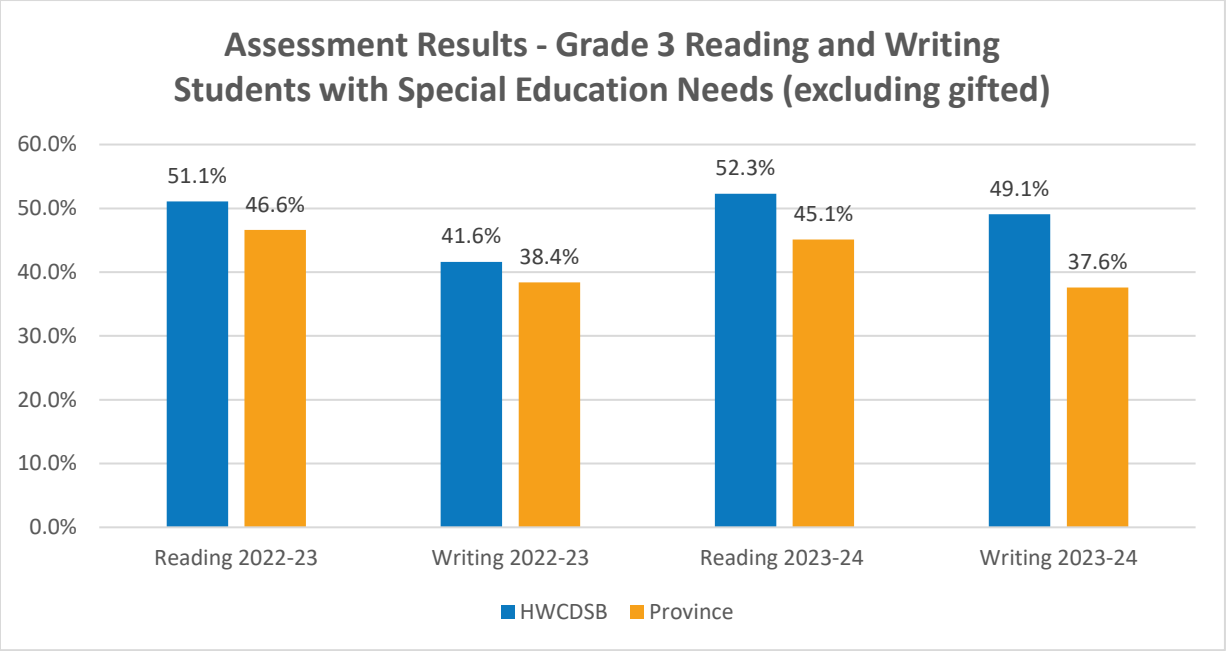

Assessment Results - Grade 3 and 6 Mathematics
80.0%
70.0%
60.0%
50.0%
40.0%
30.0%
20.0%
10.0%
0.0%
64.5%
59.7%
48.1%
49.5%
71.6%
61.3%
51.2%
50.2%
Grade 3 2022-23
Grade 6 2022-23
Grade 3 2023-24
Grade 6 2023-24
HWCDSB
Province

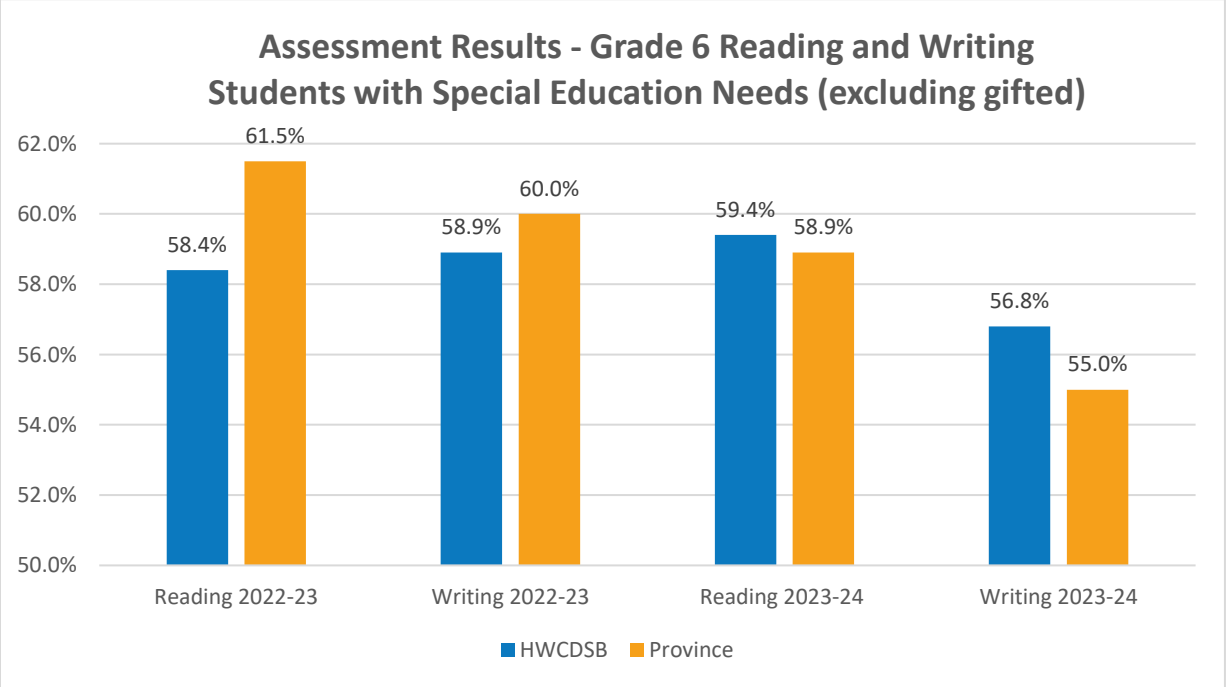

Assessment Results - Grade 9 Mathematics
60.0%
55.0%
50.0%
45.0%
40.0%
50.4%
53.7%
55.3%
53.9%
Grade 9 2022-23
Grade 9 2023-24
HWCDSB
Province

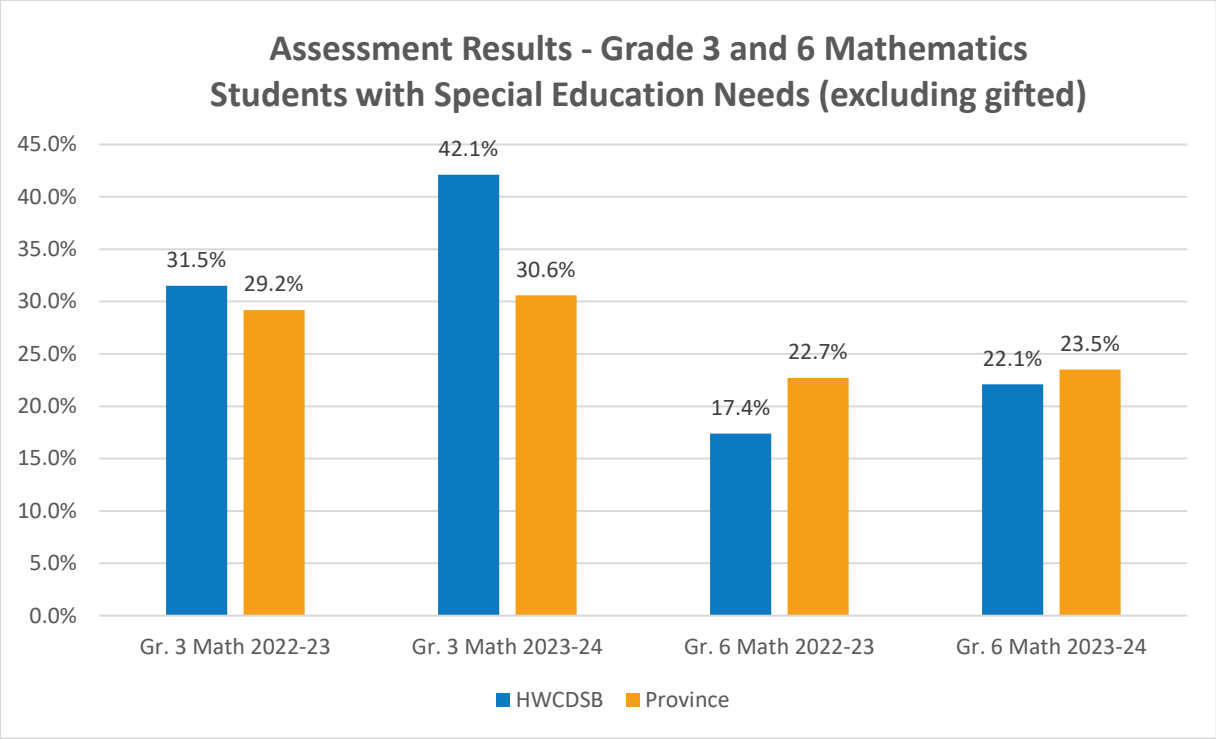

Assessment Results - Grade 10 OSSLT
90.0%
88.0%
86.0%
84.0%
82.0%
80.0%
78.0%
76.0%
74.0%
72.0%
70.0%
76.5%
84.7%
81.4%
84.5%
2022-23
2023-24
HWCDSB
Province

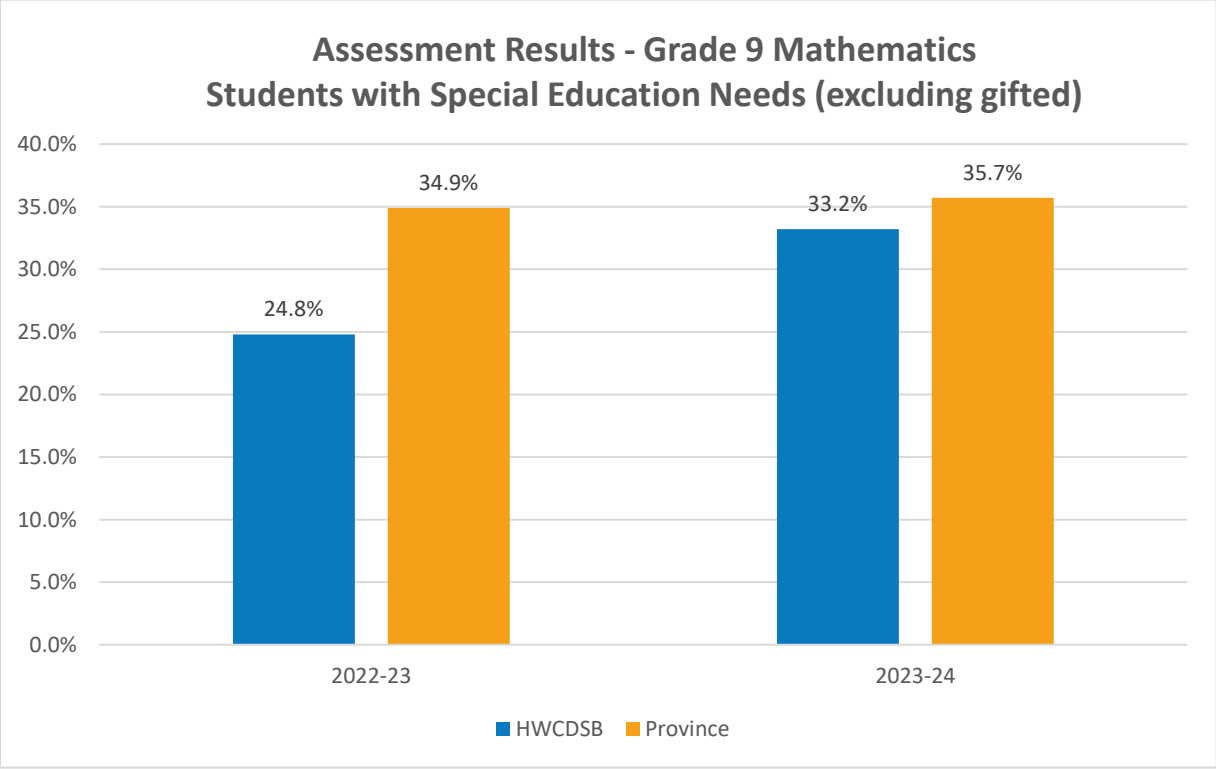
APPENDIX C

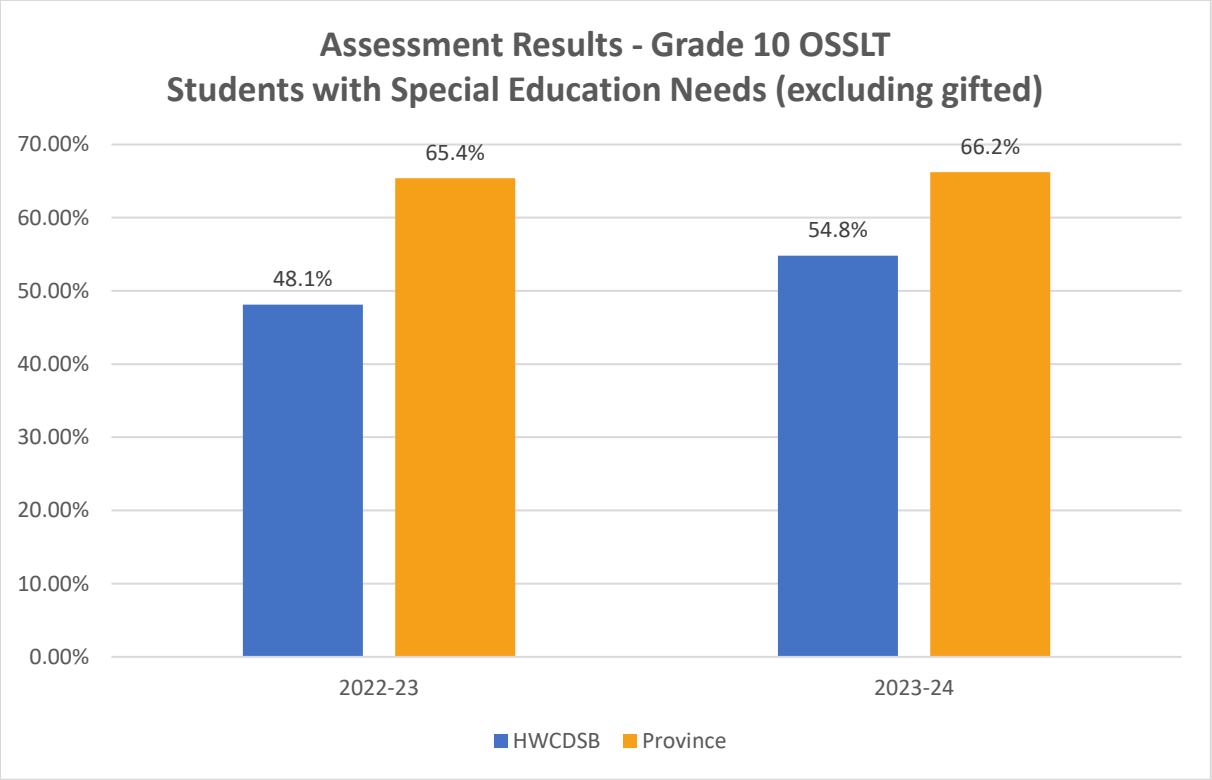
EQAO RESULTS - STUDENTS WITH SPECIAL EDUCATION NEEDS (EXCLUDING GIFTED)





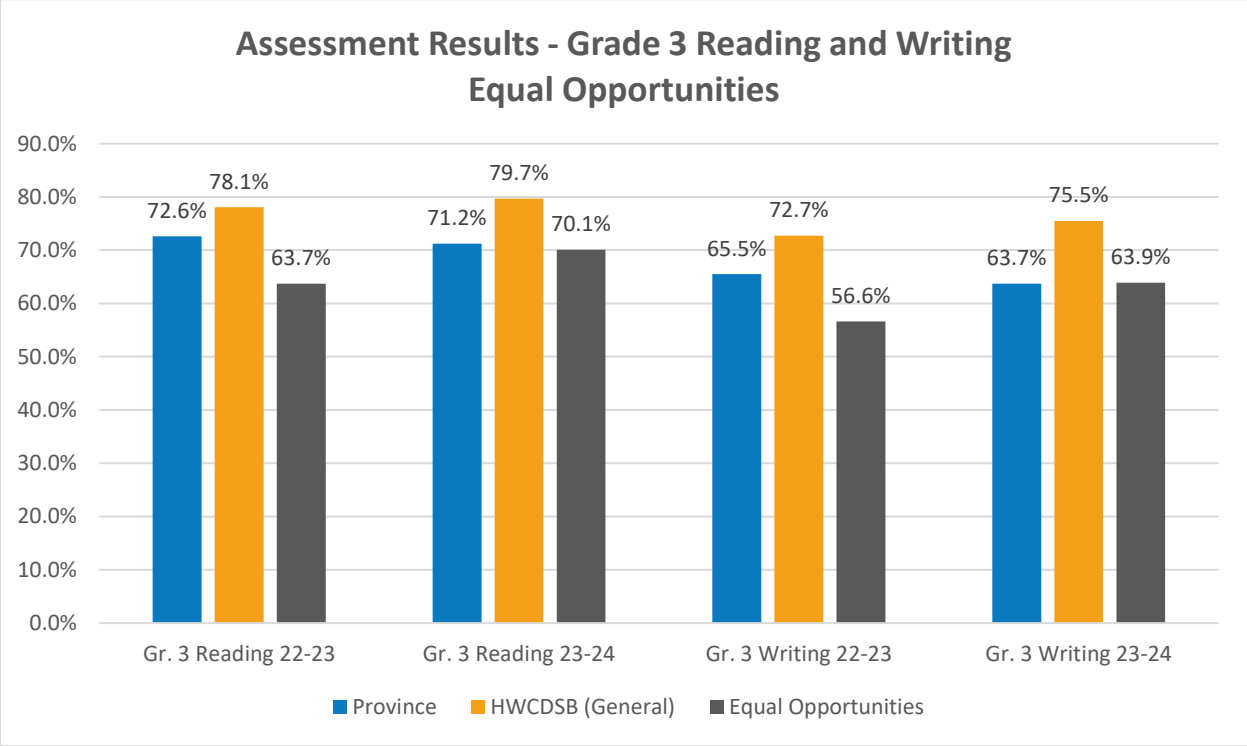

Assessment Results - Grade 3 and 6 Mathematics
Students with Special Education Needs (excluding gifted)
45.0%
40.0%
35.0%
30.0%
25.0%
20.0%
15.0%
10.0%
5.0%
0.0%
31.5%
29.2%
42.1%
30.6%
17.4%
22.7%
22.1%
23.5%
Gr. 3 Math 2022-23
Gr. 3 Math 2023-24
Gr. 6 Math 2022-23
Gr. 6 Math 2023-24
HWCDSB
Province

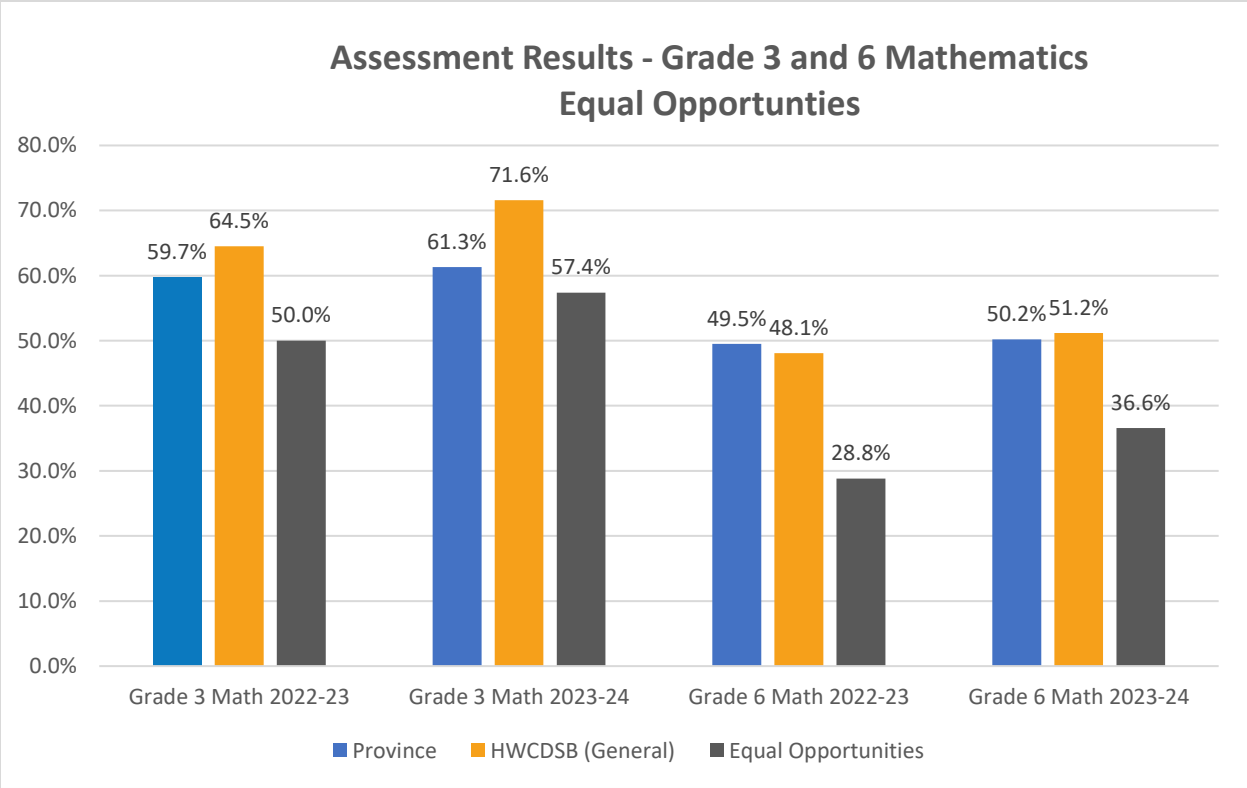

Assessment Results - Grade 9 Mathematics
Students with Special Education Needs (excluding gifted)
40.0%
35.0%
30.0%
25.0%
20.0%
15.0%
10.0%
5.0%
0.0%
24.8%
34.9%
33.2%
35.7%
2022-23
2023-24
HWCDSB
Province

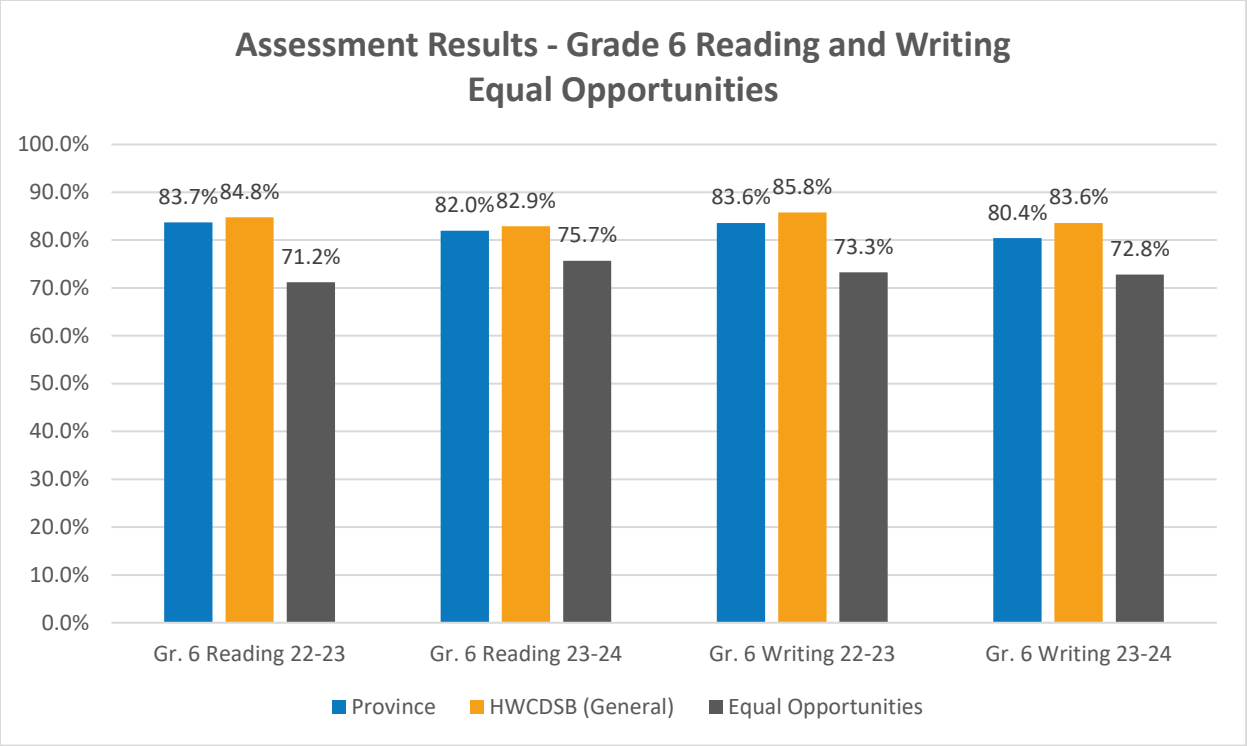

Assessment Results - Grade 10 OSSLT
Students with Special Education Needs (excluding gifted)
70.00%
60.00%
50.00%
40.00%
30.00%
20.00%
10.00%
0.00%
48.1%
65.4%
54.8%
66.2%
2022-23
2023-24
HWCDSB
Province

APPENDIX D

GRADE 3 AND 6 EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES SCHOOLS

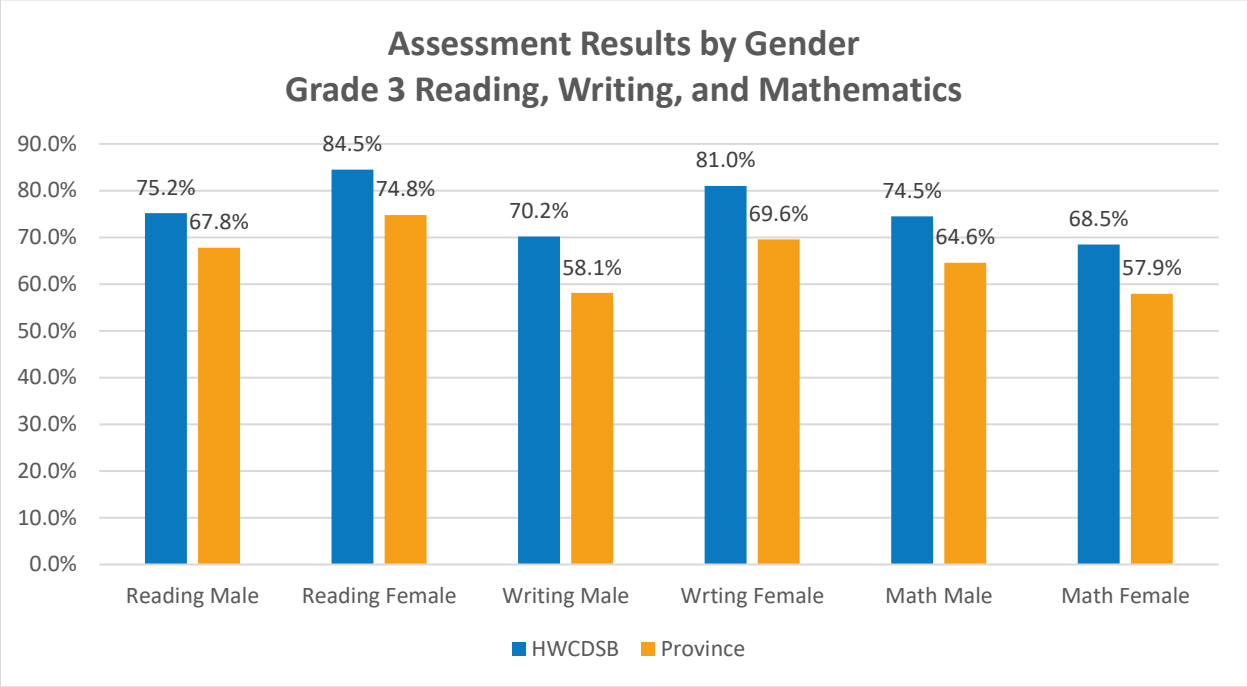


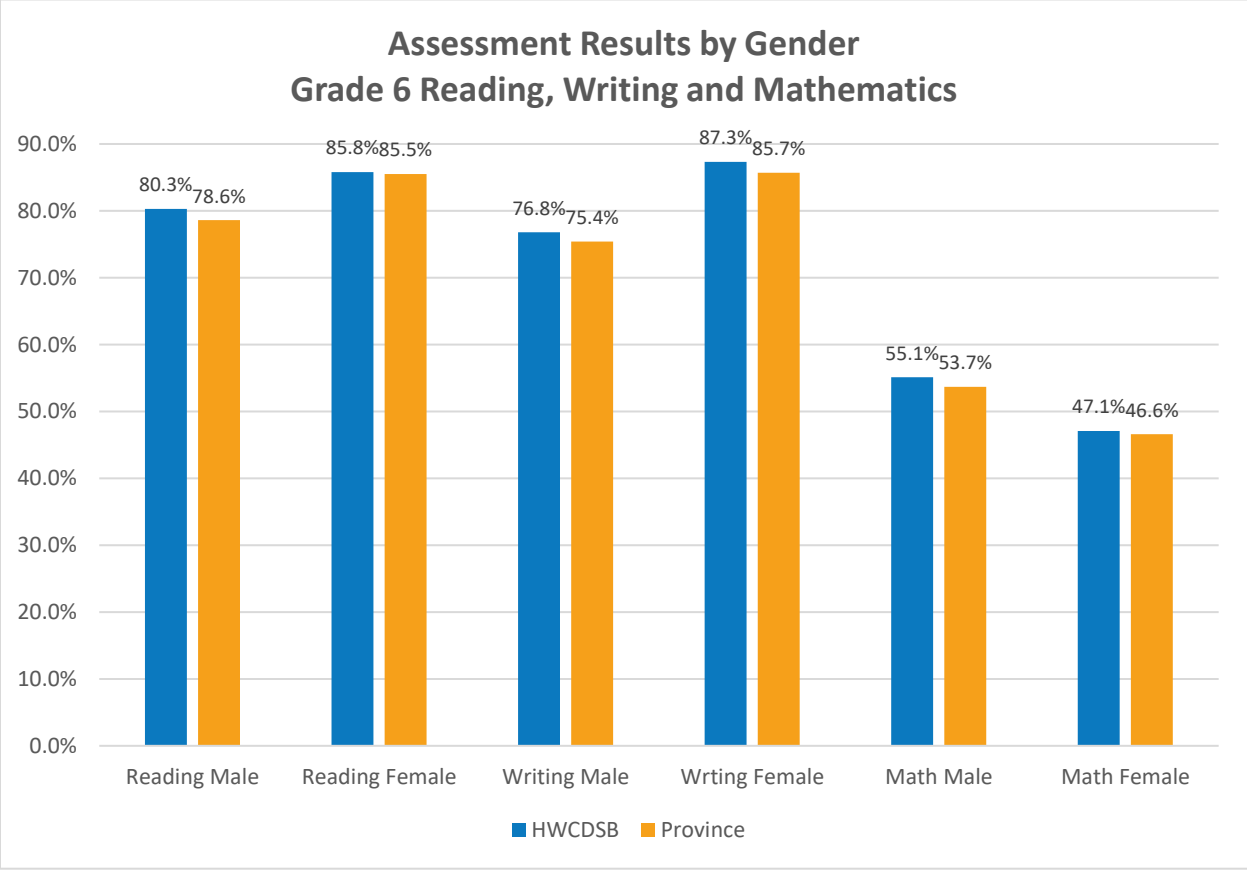


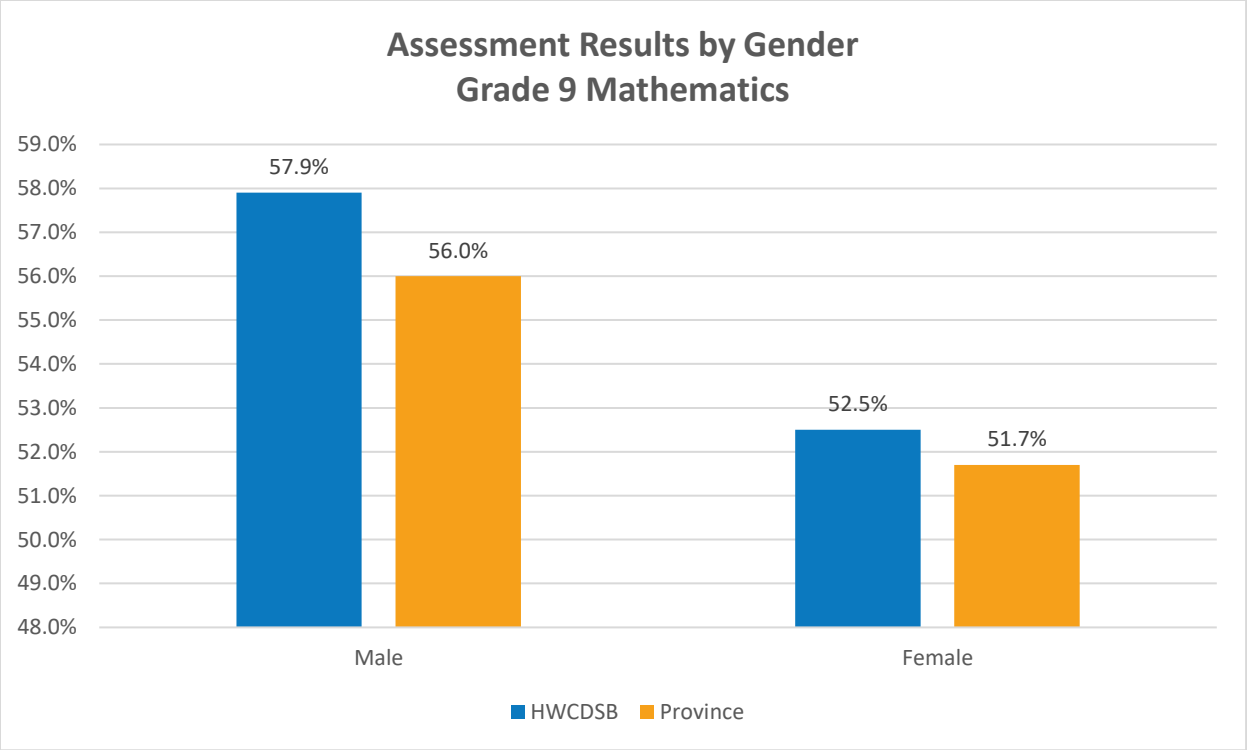

Assessment Results - Grade 6 Reading and Writing
Equal Opportunities
100.0%
90.0%
80.0%
70.0%
60.0%
50.0%
40.0%
30.0%
20.0%
10.0%
0.0%
83.7%
84.8%
71.2%
82.0%
82.9%
75.7%
83.6%
85.8%
73.3%
80.4%
83.6%
72.8%
Gr. 6 Reading 22-23
Gr. 6 Reading 23-24
Gr. 6 Writing 22-23
Gr. 6 Writing 23-24
Province
HWCDSB (General)
Equal Opportunities

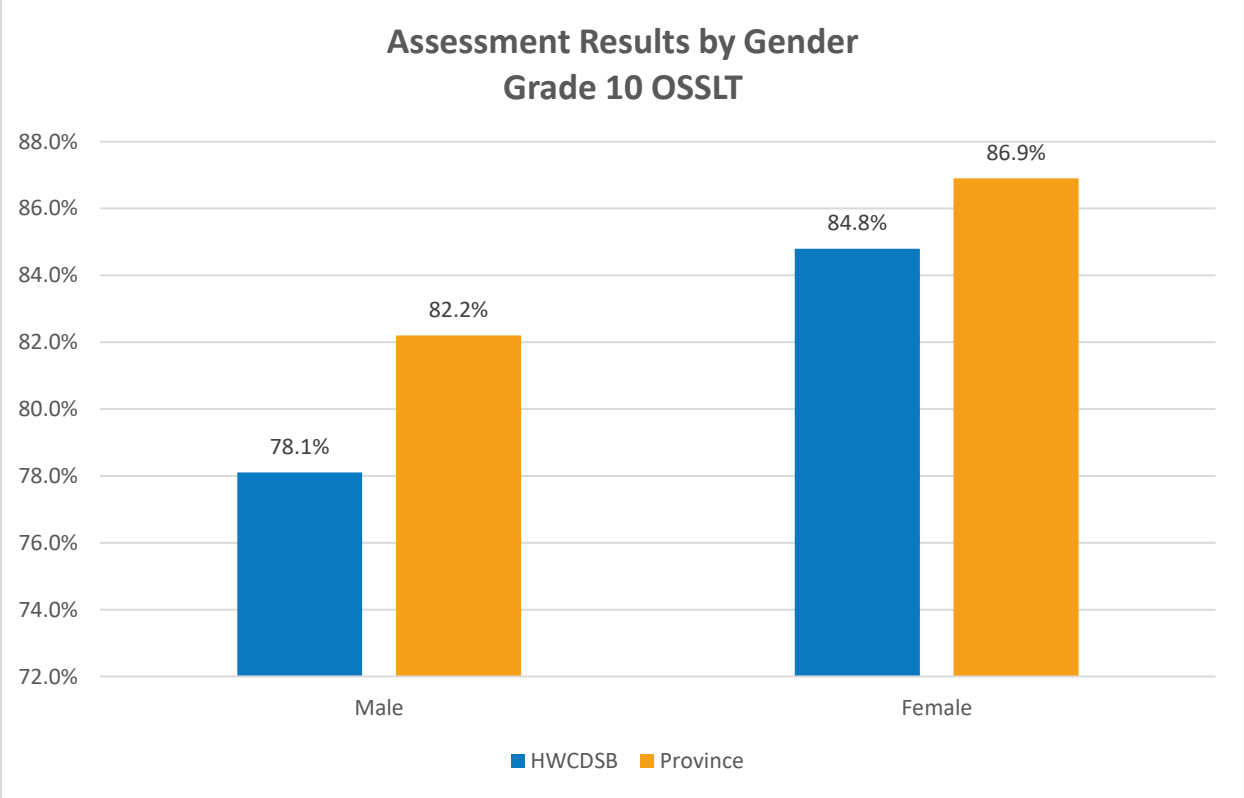
APPENDIX E

EQAO ASSESSMENTS – RESULTS BY GENDER



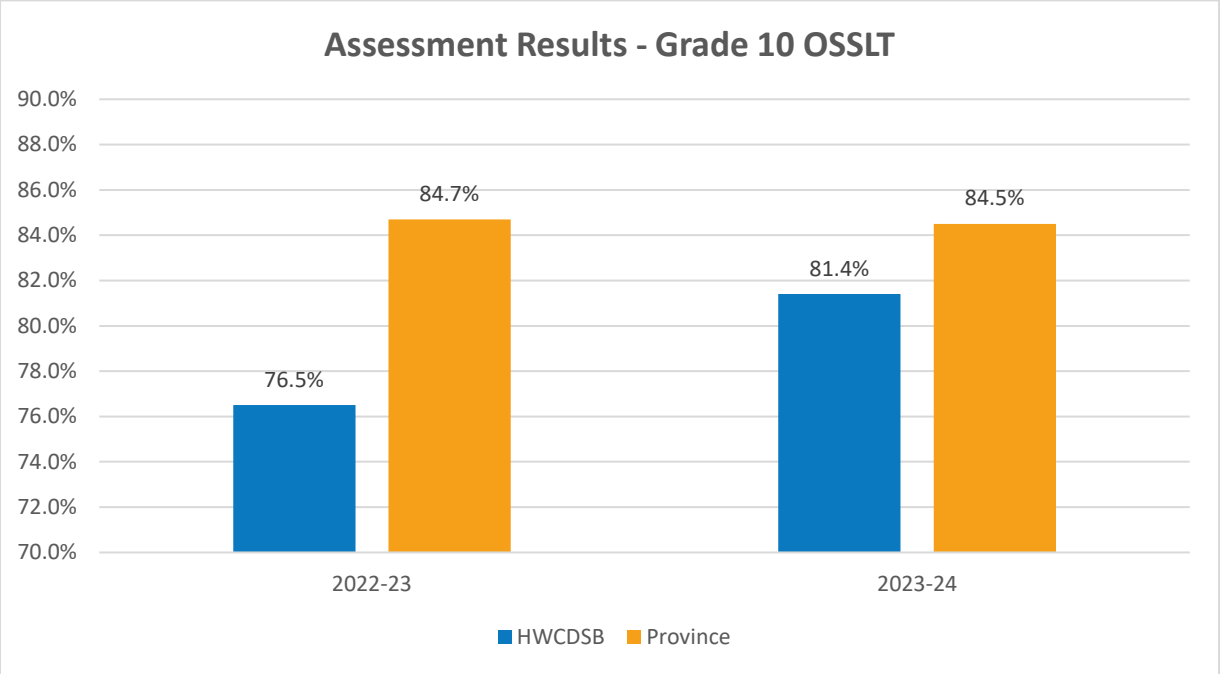


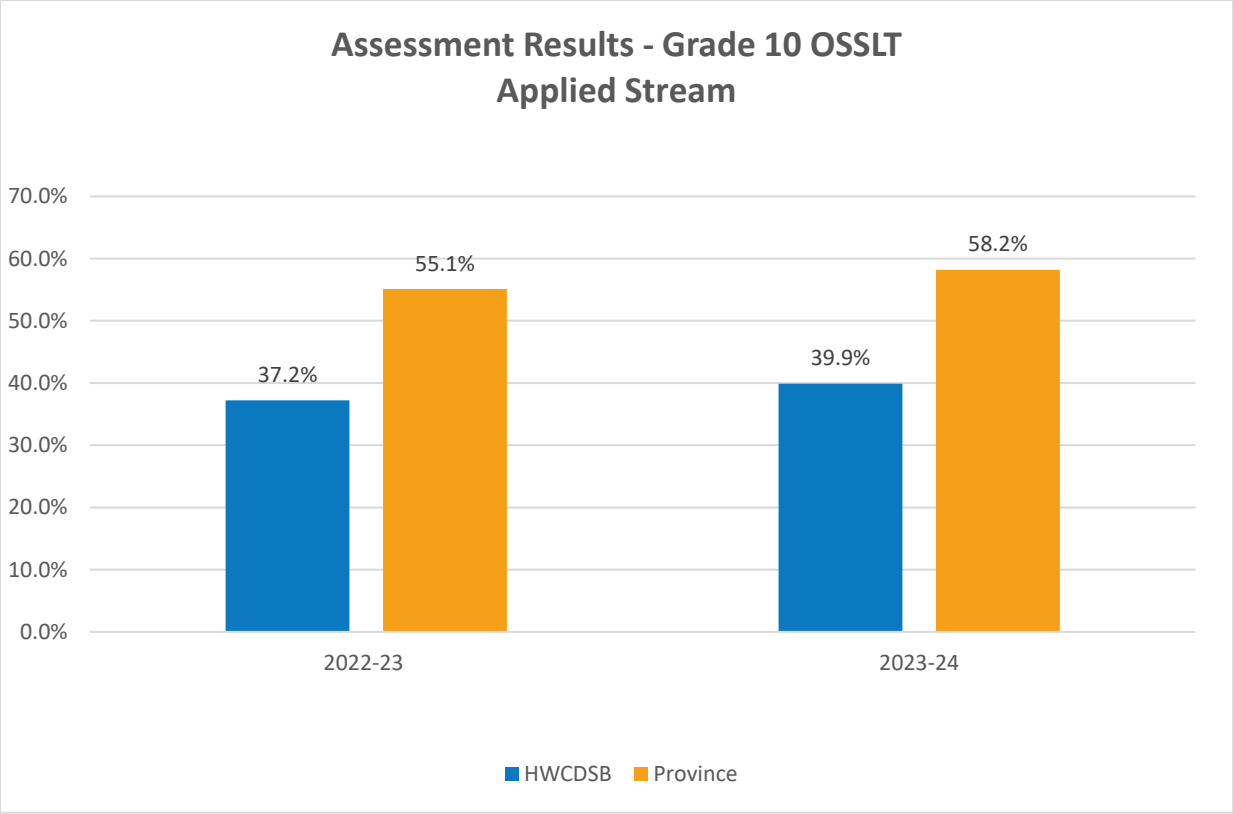

Assessment Results by Gender
Grade 9 Mathematics
59.0%
58.0%
57.0%
56.0%
55.0%
54.0%
53.0%
52.0%
51.0%
50.0%
49.0%
48.0%
57.9%
56.0%
52.5%
51.7%
Male
Female
HWCDSB
Province

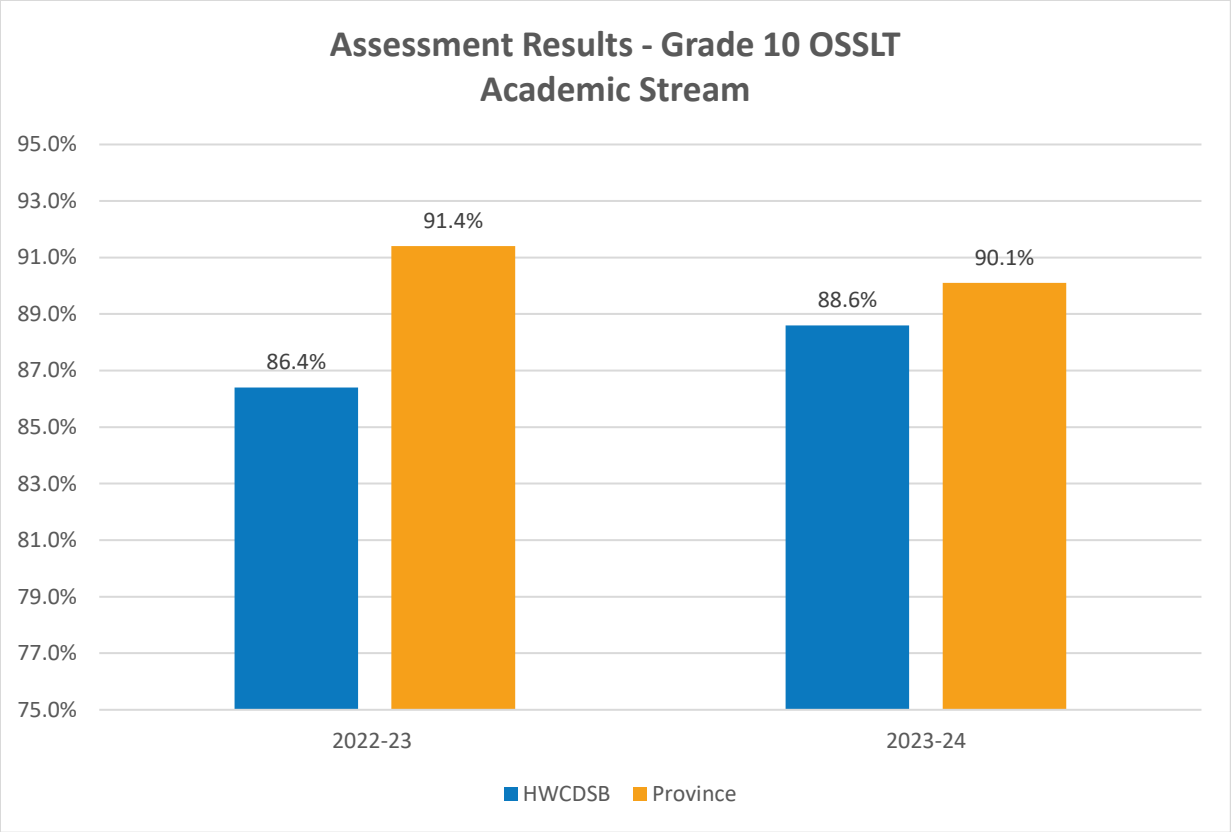

Assessment Results by Gender
Grade 10 OSSLT
88.0%
86.0%
84.0%
82.0%
80.0%
78.0%
76.0%
74.0%
72.0%
78.1%
82.2%
84.8%
86.9%
Male
Female
HWCDSB
Province

APPENDIX F

OSSLT SUCCESS RATE FTE FULLY PARTICIPATING






Assessment Results - Grade 10 OSSLT
Academic Stream
95.0%
93.0%
91.0%
89.0%
87.0%
85.0%
83.0%
81.0%
79.0%
77.0%
75.0%
86.4%
91.4%
88.6%
90.1%
2022-23
2023-24
HWCDSB
Province

REPORT **SAWB-24-8**

TO: STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING COMMITTEE

SUBJECT: HAMILTON-WENTWORTH CATHOLIC DISTRICT SCHOOL BOARD MATHEMATICS IMPROVEMENT ACTION PLAN UPDATE

DATE: TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024

2024-25 BUDGET DRIVER ALIGNMENT

Excellence: Improve student numeracy learning and achievement

ORIGIN

Director's Council

BACKGROUND

In October 2023, the Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board (HWCDSB) approved the HWCDSB Mathematics Improvement Action Plan (Appendix A), which was based on the Ministry of Education's "Taking Action in Mathematics: Look-fors by Provincial Action" (Appendix B). This report will provide an update on some of the actions taken, data about student achievement, and planned actions for the 2024-2025 school year.

COMMENT

The HWCDSB Mathematics Improvement Action Plan was built upon three priority actions.

Priority Action 1

Ensuring fidelity of curriculum implementation and use of proven instructional and assessment practices to enhance student achievement.

To support curriculum implementation in Grades 6-8, the Board facilitated an in-year purchase of Nelson's My Math Path textbooks in January 2024. Schools are now focused on the full implementation of these resources, which align with The Ontario Curriculum - Mathematics 2020 for Grades 1-8. In 2023-2024, scope and sequence documents were finalized with input and revisions from classroom teachers. For 2024-2025, this work will continue, focusing on creating similar scope and sequence documents for combined classes.

The use of Knowledgehook, a teacher-friendly digital math tool, is being promoted in all schools and saw unprecedented levels of implementation in the HWCDSB. Use of Knowledgehook increased significantly in 2023-2024, based on the number of student missions and "Mathalons" completed. To support skillful use of this digital math tool, a

“Math Summit” is planned for elementary principals on October 21, with time allocated to training principals on the effective use of the Knowledgehook dashboard. This data dashboard summarizes rates of adoption and highlights specific areas of strength and areas for improvement, based on student responses. Since students are increasingly engaged with this software, supporting principals in effectively actioning the data is of paramount importance and the right next step in Knowledgehook implementation.

Priority Action 2
Engaging in ongoing learning to strengthen mathematics content knowledge for teaching.

Professional Activity Days are being used to support teachers of mathematics. These days include a variety of workshops tailored for the various divisions. In 2023-2024, many teachers of Grades 1, 4, and 5 participated in full-day professional learning sessions entitled “High Impact Instructional Practices.” In these sessions, teachers explored the many resources available to support the classrooms, including but not limited to the centrally created Math Resource myClass Learning Management System (LMS) page, grade-specific sequence of learning documents, use of manipulatives (digital and hands-on), My Math Path Online Teaching Centre, Knowledgehook, and StrADDegy. The feedback from these sessions was overwhelmingly positive. In 2024-2025, a shift to site-specific support will be implemented, which will include small group professional collaboration facilitated by a member of the mathematics team.

In secondary schools, full-day professional development sessions with the board math lead and secondary STEM consultant will be provided at each of the 7 secondary schools for all Grade 9 mathematics teachers in October. These sessions will include a school specific EQAO data review and training on the effective implementation of the various resources available to Grade 9 teachers, many of which underwent a comprehensive revision in 2023-2024. Gap Closing Mathematics (GLE 1OM) teachers will be provided time and training to explore the revised resource, which is designed to meet the needs of Grade 9 students who have learning gaps in mathematics. All teachers will receive an introduction to Knowledgehook, as secondary uptake was limited in 2023-2024.

Priority Action 3
Knowing the mathematics learner and ensuring mathematical tasks, interventions, and supports are relevant and responsive.

Eighteen of the highest priority elementary schools in the HWCDSB that were chosen either through Ministry mandate or past EQAO results are receiving weekly support from one of six teacher math facilitators. They work directly with individual or small groups of students who have been identified as needing additional support to close learning gaps. These teachers also address priority action 1 by supporting coding and other curriculum areas identified in consultation with school principals.

Materials which were created and/or revised in 2023-2024 to support students with learning gaps in Grades 7 through 9 will be implemented in 2024-2025. The intent of

these materials is to focus students on the key expectations that will support a successful transition to the Grade 9 de-streamed curriculum.

EQAO Results from Classrooms supported by teacher math facilitators in 2023-2024

The EQAO results from the 18 schools who received support from the teacher math facilitators is summarized below:

Assessment	Province	HWCDSB (All Schools)	HWCDSB Priority Classrooms	Change from 2022-23
Grade 3 Mathematics	61.3%*	71.6%	64.6%	↑ 9.9%
Grade 6 Mathematics	50.2%*	51.2%	43.1%	↑ 5.7%

*The provincial average above is a general average of all schools in Ontario.

The improvement shown by this subset of our schools exceeded the improvement of the HWCDSB, in general. The data suggests that the student-centred, small group approach was effective in supporting these schools in 2023-2024. All schools, including those not identified for weekly support, received classroom visits by the board math lead, the elementary numeracy consultant, or one of the six teacher math facilitators to prepare the students for the EQAO assessments. The focus was on effectively implementing the centrally created review materials, including mock tests based on sample tasks from the curriculum, booklets containing EQAO released questions, and workbooks which encouraged students to show their thinking prior to submitting answers.

The following schools have been identified for weekly support in 2024-2025. These schools were chosen based on the 2021-2022 Grade 3 EQAO data and on historical data trends:

Annunciation of Our Lord CES	St. Eugene CES	St. Margaret Mary CES
Holy Name of Jesus CES	St. Francis Xavier CES	St. Marguerite d'Youville CES
Our Lady of Lourdes CES	St. John the Baptist CES	St. Matthew CES
St. Agnes CES	St. Kateri Tekakwitha CES	St. Michael CES
St. Ann (Hamilton) CES	St. Lawrence CES	St. Patrick CES
St. David CES	St. Luke CES	Sts. Peter and Paul CES

Conclusion

The HWCDSB Mathematics Improvement Action Plan emphasizes three priority actions to enhance effectiveness across the K-12 mathematics continuum. These actions require coordination of resources and efforts at the board, school, and classroom levels to foster increased student learning and achievement. Data continues to drive the decisions made to support the HWCDSB mathematics program.

RECOMMENDATION

THAT THE REPORT, HAMILTON-WENTWORTH CATHOLIC DISTRICT SCHOOL BOARD MATHEMATICS IMPROVEMENT ACTION PLAN UPDATE, DATED TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024, BE RECEIVED.

SUBMITTED BY: B. DALY
ASSISTANT SUPERINTENDENT OF EDUCATION
BOARD MATH LEAD

D. HANSEN
DIRECTOR OF EDUCATION

HWCDSB Mathematics Improvement Action Plan

Believing, Achieving, Serving

At the Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board, we profess our faith in everything that we say and do. By prioritizing improvement in mathematics, we seek to fulfill our board mission to "enable all learners to realize the fullness of humanity of which Our Lord Jesus Christ is the model." This learning process is most effective when it is anchored at home in family life and nurtured in both the school community and parish. Learning flourishes when it is fully embraced by the learner as a personal responsibility.

Priority Action: Ensuring fidelity of curriculum implementation and use of instructional and assessment practices with a proven track record of enhancing student achievement	Priority Action: Engaging in ongoing learning to strengthen mathematics content knowledge for teaching	Priority Action: Knowing the mathematics learner and ensuring mathematical tasks, interventions, and supports are relevant and responsive
Board • Align resources, including staffing, with mathematical priorities. Through the hiring process, identify teachers with mathematical strengths for priority hiring or purposeful placement. • Leverage digital mathematics resources (e.g. Edwin, Mathify) to support curriculum-based practices at home to ensure fidelity to all curriculum expectations and to increase student engagement. • Provide relevant and meaningful resources and supports to increase the implementation of curriculum-aligned course plans, lessons, and digital resources (e.g., Edwin, Knowledgehook, Math Resources MyClass page, monthly mathematics feature). • Offer centrally developed Sequences of Learning plans that incorporate new resources such as My Math Path and Knowledgehook. These plans include direct links to engaging, open-ended problem-solving tasks, diverse assessment opportunities, and encourage the adoption of high-impact instructional practices (e.g. direct instruction, math conversations, small-group instruction, flexible groupings), including the use of developmentally appropriate tools and representations.	**Board** • Build capacity through ongoing professional learning opportunities by encouraging the acquisition of Additional Qualification courses in mathematics. Prioritize mathematics content knowledge for teaching in professional learning opportunities and in allocation of resources, including staffing. • Identify priority schools, including but not limited to the Equal Opportunity schools, for additional programming and materials to support student learning and provide targeted interventions. • Evaluate the effectiveness of intervention programs and share effective strategies across all schools in the system. • Increase commitment to professional development in mathematics across all grades, with a focus on the junior grades. • Consider the implementation of rotary when it serves the learning needs of the school community.	**Board** • Use attendance and achievement data to identify priority schools, classes, and students for targeted interventions and additional support. • Elementary Mathematics Facilitators will work in priority schools, collaborating with educators and administrators to provide targeted interventions, instructional, and assessment support to Grade 3 and Grade 6 students and teachers. • Promote the use of accessible mathematics resources to empower students, parents/guardians, and teachers in supporting all students. These resources include Mathify, Knowledgehook, Edwin, in-school tutoring, summer school preparation courses, and more. • Through the HWCDSB Secondary 1:1 device distribution program, provide equitable access to digital mathematics tools at school and home and provide increased access in elementary schools.

"For no one can lay any foundation other than the one already laid, which is Jesus Christ." 1 Corinthians 3:11

Priority Action: Ensuring fidelity of curriculum implementation and use of instructional and assessment practices with a proven track record of enhancing student achievement	Priority Action: Engaging in ongoing learning to strengthen mathematics content knowledge for teaching	Priority Action: Knowing the mathematics learner and ensuring mathematical tasks, interventions, and supports are relevant and responsive
School • Promote and monitor the use of centrally created scope and sequence documents, LMS resources, and digital mathematics tools to ensure fidelity to the curriculum. • Make intentional staffing decisions to ensure teachers of key grades have deep understanding of the curriculum, including instructional practices to effectively teach and assess curriculum concepts and skills. • Engage in ongoing professional learning (e.g., in grade/division/department meetings, learning teams, classroom visits) of the curriculum, including making connections across strands.	**School** • Collaborate with Board Math Lead to identify school/division/grade mathematics content knowledge focus areas, including planning and monitoring associated professional learning. • Promote resilience, perseverance, and positive attitudes towards mathematics through school communications, hosting family math or STEM nights, engaging in activities like FIRST Lego League and FIRST Robotics, participating in junior mathematics challenges, grade-level mathematics contests (e.g., University of Waterloo, Beaver computing challenge), and fostering growth mindsets while encouraging participation in enrichment opportunities. • Engage in regular collaborative meetings (e.g., team teaching, collaborative analysis of student work, school and/or board networks, classroom visits) to deepen knowledge of mathematics, curriculum, instructional starting points, interventions, and assessment and evaluation practices.	**School** • Integrate HWCDSB Mathematics Improvement Action Plan items into school improvement plans. • Monitor and respond to students' perception of and confidence in mathematics (e.g., written surveys, student conferencing, family, and community engagements). • Integrate high-impact instructional practices (e.g. direct instruction, mathematics conversations, small-group instruction, flexible groupings) across grades/divisions that foster student ownership of mathematics, while ensuring all students have accessible entry points into learning. • Determine key content areas, informed by EQAO data, including Strands and Skills reports, to determine where students may be struggling and if there are gaps between classroom and EQAO achievement.
Classroom • Draw explicit connections between mathematical processes and lesson plans using high-impact instructional practices (e.g. direct instruction, mathematics conversations, small-group instruction, flexible groupings) • Implement the use of effective assessment tools for curriculum expectations and long-term essential mathematical understandings. • Use a variety of assessment tools to inform next steps in curriculum implementation (e.g., StrADDegy, Knowledgehook, LMS quizzes, peer/self assessment, exit slips or other sources of student voice).	**Classroom** • Access resources (e.g., teacher supports on elementary LMS page, secondary LMS class sites), experts (e.g., secondary and elementary mathematics consultants, school mathematics facilitators), and professional learning to continuously develop content knowledge for teaching. • Develop expertise in foundational mathematics concepts to deliver updated curricular concepts (e.g., coding, financial literacy). • Model positive and curious attitudes towards mathematics to create an environment where students are excited to learn mathematics and develop into confident mathematics learners.	**Classroom** • Adapt instructional practices in response to data collected from multiple, frequent assessment opportunities. • Understand and respond to students' mathematics strengths, needs, and interests using a variety of resources, including Individual Education Plans (IEPs) and input from special education teachers and educational assistants. • Plan, teach, and assess learning in culturally responsive and relevant ways that motivate students to take ownership of their learning and progress in mathematics. • Monitor and re-engage students at the earliest sign that attendance is impacting learning and implement the school and board's absence strategies.

"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit." John 15:5

Taking action in mathematics | Look-fors by provincial action

Math achievement efforts across the province should include multiple proven evidence-informed strategies and approaches to address local learning needs in schools.

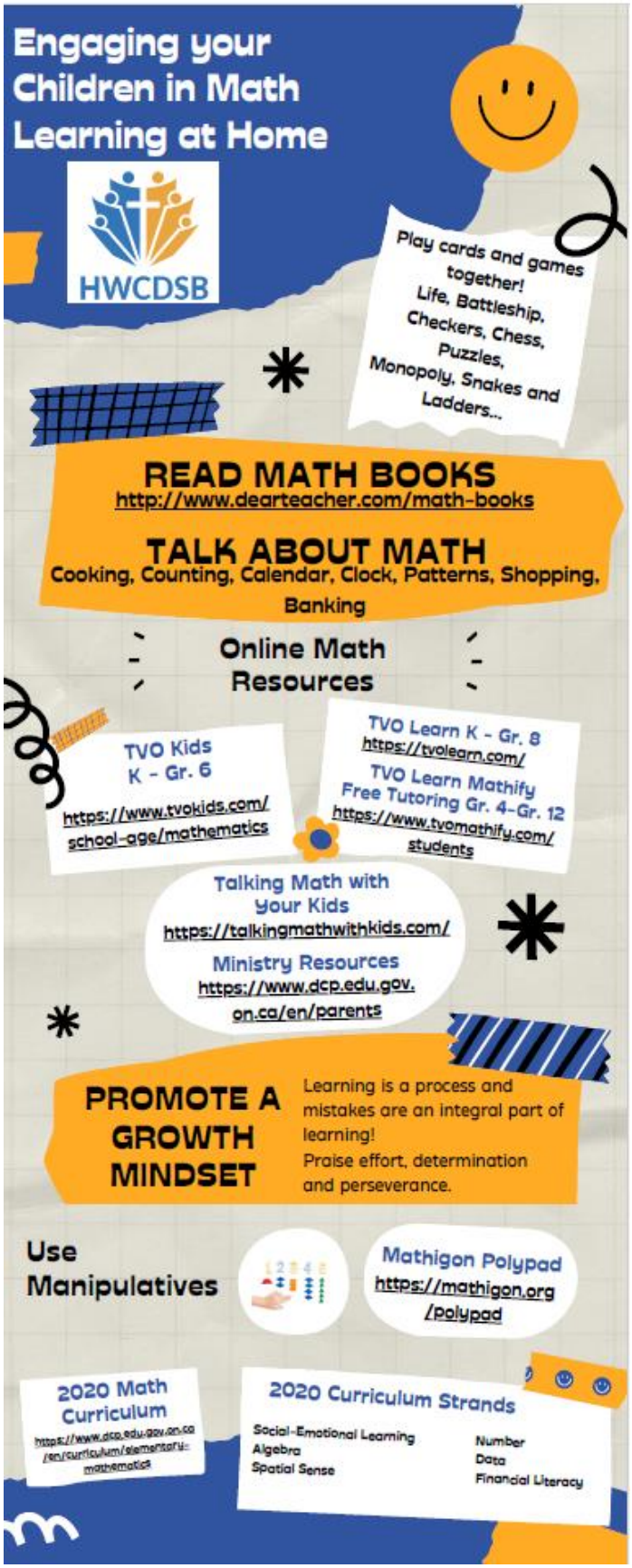
The ministry has worked with researchers, math specialists, and school boards to identify three interwoven math actions to be prioritized in the 2023–24 school year. Board Math Leads, as they determine board and school priorities in mathematics achievement, will develop, implement, and monitor a Math Achievement Action Plan that includes meaningful and measurable key performance indicators (KPIs) aligned with each of the priority actions below.

A mathematics community of excellence: In order to promote effective math instruction, it is important for educators to foster mathematics communities in classrooms and schools, and to recognize that not all students learn math in the same way or within the same time frames. Effective math instruction is supported by an inclusive, positive, and safe learning environment where all students feel valued and engaged, and in which educators clearly communicate expectations and establish norms and routines with their students at the beginning of instruction. Educators at all levels of the school system have a role to play in establishing a culture of excellence in mathematics and setting conditions for success. This includes leaders reviewing practices to determine barriers to success, creating accountability, and attending to mathematics attitudes and mindsets in school and system improvement plans.

PRIORITY ACTION: Ensuring fidelity of curriculum implementation and use of instructional and assessment practices with a proven track record of enhancing student achievement	**PRIORITY ACTION:** Engaging in ongoing learning to strengthen mathematics content knowledge for teaching	**PRIORITY ACTION:** Knowing the mathematics learner, and ensuring mathematical tasks, interventions and supports are relevant and responsive
• How are all educators throughout the system focused on developing a comprehensive understanding and precise implementation of the mathematics curriculum? • How do grade, course, and daily lesson plans reflect the current curriculum, including the mathematical processes and connections between curriculum strands?	• What systems, supports, and resources are available to support teachers and leaders in determining a focus area for their math content knowledge development? • How are all educators engaged in ongoing learning that strengthens their own mathematics knowledge, skills, and attitudes about math teaching and learning?	• How is student assessment data and prior mathematics knowledge used to guide interventions and planning? • How do educators learn about the mathematics strengths, needs and interests of all students to inform their instructional decisions? • How are educators supporting inclusion and engagement for all students, especially those with diverse learning needs?
Board • Prioritize understanding of the curriculum and the continuum of learning across grades • Align resources, including staffing, with mathematics priorities • Provide guidelines, resources and supports for mathematics curriculum-aligned long-range plans, unit plans, and lesson plans • Leverage digital math resources to support curriculum-linked practice at home	**Board** • Utilize student achievement data and student work to establish focus areas for mathematics professional learning • Understand the importance of the relationship between mathematics content knowledge and effective mathematics instruction, as it relates to student achievement • Prioritize mathematics content knowledge for teaching in professional learning opportunities and in allocation of resources, including staffing	**Board** • Align Math Improvement Action Plan with board improvement planning, including using student assessment and demographic data to identify areas of focus • Build capacity in data analysis resources to understand mathematics achievement from a variety of sources, including alignment between EQAO, report cards, and locally-developed assessment tools/tasks • Provide a digital math tool to support student mathematics learning at home and/or at school, that can be used by teachers to understand current student learning levels and provide targeted supports for students • Develop a system-wide attendance strategy for students with more than 10 days of absences as part of board's existing prolonged absence strategy

School • Directly connect long-range plans, course outlines, lesson plans, and reporting to current curriculum expectations (e.g., educators consult the Curriculum and Resources website regularly to ensure alignment) • Engage in ongoing professional learning (e.g., in grade/division/ department meetings, learning teams, classroom visits) on the curriculum, including making connections across strands • Make intentional staffing decisions to ensure teachers of key grades have deep understanding of the curriculum, including understanding instructional practices to effectively teach and assess curriculum concepts and skills	**School** • Collaborate with Board Math Lead to identify school/division/grade mathematics content knowledge focus areas, including planning and monitoring associated professional learning • Engage in regular collaborative meetings (e.g., team teaching, collaborative analysis of student work, school and/or board networks, classroom visits) to deepen knowledge of mathematics, curriculum, instructional starting points, and interventions • Engage families and communities to support different ways of understanding and doing mathematics (e.g., families and communities are asked to contribute to planning and execution of family math nights)	**School** • Determine key content areas, informed by EQAO data, including Strands and Skills reports, to determine where students may be struggling most and if there are gaps between classroom and EQAO achievement • Integrate common open and parallel learning tasks across grades/divisions that foster student ownership of mathematics, while ensuring all students have accessible entry points into learning • Monitor and respond to students' perception of and confidence in math (e.g., written surveys, student conferencing, family and community engagements) • Develop processes to identify and monitor achievement of students achieving below Level 2 in mathematics and provide ongoing supports so that students can access grade-level curriculum
Classroom • Draw explicit connections to and between mathematical processes and in lesson planning and use proven instructional and assessment practices (e.g., High-Impact Instructional Practices) • Connect instruction and assessment to curriculum expectations and long-term essential mathematical understandings using developmental continuums • Use a variety of assessment tools to inform next steps in curriculum implementation (e.g., teacher prompts on the Curriculum and Resources website, exit cards to inform lesson planning in response to student needs)	**Classroom** • Access resources (e.g., teacher supports on the Curriculum and Resources website), experts (e.g., curriculum consultant, school math facilitator), and professional learning to continuously develop content knowledge for teaching • Model a positive and curious learning stance with mathematics to create an environment where students are excited to learn mathematics and develop into confident math learners (e.g., regularly using "think-alouds", making the problem-solving process explicit, integrating math talk prompts and conversations, co-solving mathematics puzzles/ problems with students)	**Classroom** • Adapt lesson planning in response to data collected from multiple, frequent assessment opportunities (e.g., interviews, conversations, student agendas, exit tickets, portfolios, surveys) • Understand and respond to student mathematics strengths, needs and interests using a variety of sources, including the Curriculum and Resources website, Individual Education Plans (IEPs), and collaboration with special education teachers and educational assistants • Plan, teach, and assess learning in culturally responsive and relevant ways that motivate students to take ownership of their learning of, and progress in, mathematics • Monitor and re-engage students at the earliest sign that attendance is impacting learning (e.g., at 3 days and 6 days of absence) and implement board's 10-day and prolonged absence strategy

APPENDIX C


Engaging your Children in Math Learning at Home
HWCDSB
Play cards and games together!
Life, Battleship, Checkers, Chess, Puzzles, Monopoly, Snakes and Ladders...
READ MATH BOOKS
http://www.dearteacher.com/math-books
TALK ABOUT MATH
Cooking, Counting, Calendar, Clock, Patterns, Shopping, Banking
Online Math Resources
TVO Kids
K - Gr. 6
https://www.tvokids.com/school-age/mathematics
TVO Learn K - Gr. 8
https://tvolearn.com/
TVO Learn Mathify
Free Tutoring Gr. 4-Gr. 12
https://www.tvomathify.com/students
Talking Math with Your Kids
https://talkingmathwithkids.com/
Ministry Resources
https://www.dcp.edu.gov.on.ca/en/parents
PROMOTE A GROWTH MINDSET
Learning is a process and mistakes are an integral part of learning!
Praise effort, determination and perseverance.
Use Manipulatives
Mathigon Polypad
https://mathigon.org/polypad
2020 Math Curriculum
https://www.dcp.edu.gov.on.ca/en/curriculum/elementary-mathematics
2020 Curriculum Strands
Social-Emotional Learning
Algebra
Spatial Sense
Number
Data
Financial Literacy

REPORT **SAWB-24-8**

TO: STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT & WELL-BEING REPORT

SUBJECT: HEALTHY SCHOOLS CERTIFICATION

DATE: TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024

2024-25 BUDGET DRIVER ALIGNMENT

Good Stewardship: Promote our commitment to good stewardship of creation

ORIGIN

Director's Council

BACKGROUND

The Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board (HWCDSB), in partnership with the Ontario Physical and Health Education Association (OPHEA), Physical and Health Education Canada (PHE Canada), and Ever Active Schools Alberta, continues to promote the Healthy Schools Certification (HSC) to support the mental and physical well-being of students, staff, and communities. This initiative aligns with the Ontario Foundation for Healthy Schools to assist schools in planning and implementing health-related activities based on the school's priorities.

This report reviews the outcomes of the 2023-2024 HSC process and outlines strategies for continued engagement.

COMMENT

The HSC is available to all publicly funded schools across Canada. The process, built on a 4-step framework, guides schools to:

- Assemble a Healthy School Action Team;
- Identify needs, assets, and key health topics;
- Develop and execute an action plan; and,
- Celebrate and reflect on their accomplishments.

In the 2023-2024 academic year, schools chose from six key health topics: Mental Health, Physical Activity, Healthy Eating, Injury Prevention, Growth & Development, and Substance Use.

Key Findings:
Participation by HWCDSB Schools in the 2023-2024 Healthy Schools Certification

During the 2023-2024 school year, 45 HWCDSB schools participated in the HSC. A comprehensive summary for the HWCDSB has been completed by OPHEA and is

included in this report (Appendix A). The following highlights are significant and demonstrate the commitment of staff and students to the project:

- A total of 45 schools participated in the certification process in 2023-2024, an increase from 41 in the previous year.
- 36 schools earned Gold status, 4 earned Silver, and 5 earned Bronze.
- HWCDSB saw a significant increase in students impacted by the program, with a total of 25,153 students (up from 18,380 in 2022-2023).
- 100% of participants reported that the HSC had a positive impact on student health and well-being.
- 89% of participants noted a stronger focus on health and wellness at the school level, a decrease from 92% in the previous year.
- 83% reported higher student engagement.
- 94% of schools plan to continue their participation in the 2024-2025 academic year.
- 87% of schools included the Healthy Schools Certification as part of their School Improvement and Equity Plan, a figure consistent with the previous year.
- 100% of schools reported a positive impact on student health.
- 72% reported an increased sense of student belonging.
- Schools continued to integrate Catholic activities, with 82% including faith components in their plans including Christian Meditation, beginning activities with a prayer, rosary, and prayer clubs.

Participation by HWCDSB School in the 2023- 2024 Healthy School Certification

Previous Years Participation in OPHEA Healthy Schools Certification

2017-18	2018-19	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24
7	6	1	0	22	41	45

The HSC has become part of the HWCDSB Mental Health and Well-being Annual Action Plan. This alignment leverages the work currently taking place at the school level and places continued emphasis on supporting the mental health and well-being of the school community.

School Supports for the 2023-2024 Healthy School Certification Project

To assist registered schools with the tools and resources required to manage the certification process the following strategic supports were shared with all school HSC teams:

- Monthly HSC newsletters sent to schools highlighting timelines, tips and collaborative projects taking place;
- OPHEA and PHE Canada providing school leads with updates and resources on managing the certification online dashboard;

- Seven Public Health Nurses assigned to 16 target schools to assist with the completion of projects and collecting and entering data on dashboard;
- The Hamilton Public Health Nurse Liaison assigned to support HWCDSB was available to consult with schools regarding aspects of the certification process;
- Hamilton Public Health Dietitian and Physical Activity Specialist provided support with the implementation of projects; and,
- Virtual information sessions were offered to school staff during staff and Catholic School Council meetings.

Next Steps:

- The goal is to increase school participation to 100% by the 2024-2025 school year.
- Continued collaboration with community partners will be promoted.
- The HWCDSB's 2024-2025 Mental Health and Well-Being Annual Action Plan will also be integrated, focusing on aligning mental health priorities with the Healthy Schools Certification initiatives.
- Additional supports from School Mental Health Ontario (SMHO), OPHEA, PHE Canada, HWCDSB central staff, including Child and Youth Workers will be offered to schools new to the HSC process.
- Schools will leverage social media and the HWCDSB website to promote HSC initiatives.

RECOMMENDATION

THAT THE REPORT, HEALTHY SCHOOLS CERTIFICATION, DATED TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024, BE RECEIVED.

PREPARED BY: E. NIEMIEC
STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT CONSULTANT K-8

SUBMITTED BY: M. HUCAL
SUPERINTENDENT OF EDUCATION

D. HANSEN
DIRECTOR OF EDUCATION

APPENDIX A

Sample Primary Student Voice Survey

IS MY SCHOOL A HEALTHY SCHOOL? PRIMARY DIVISION SURVEY

What do you like about your school?

_____

_____

Name 2 things that happen at school that help you to be healthy?

_____

_____

Circle 3 things you like at school.

Playing with Friends	Recess
Snacks and Lunch Time	Praying
Learning	Teachers
Being Active in the Gym	Feeling Safe
Being part of a Group	Working Alone

Draw a picture of you doing things that are good for your health at school. (use the back of the page)

Tips: What does healthy look like at school?

What does healthy sound like at school?

What does healthy feel like at school?

Sample of Identified School Assets



IDENTIFICATION OF ASSETS TEMPLATE

Name of Asset	Description of Asset	Health Topic(s) Addressed
Clubs & Groups	• List clubs/groups such as Health Action Team, Diversity, Wellness, ELL, Positive Space, Indigenous	☐ Physical Activity ☐ Healthy Eating ☐ Injury Prevention ☐ Growth and Development ☐ Mental Health ☐ Substance Use ☐ All Health Topics
Existing Committees and Other Supports	• Teams and supports such as School Council, Mental Health Leadership team, Child & Youth Workers, Social Workers	☐ Physical Activity ☐ Healthy Eating ☐ Injury Prevention ☐ Growth and Development ☐ Mental Health ☐ Substance Use ☐ All Health Topics
Physical Environment	• Green space and/or tarmac • Outdoor classroom • Playground – natural, equipment, markings • Welcoming physical environment – art displays, calming space	☐ Physical Activity ☐ Healthy Eating ☐ Injury Prevention ☐ Growth and Development ☐ Mental Health ☐ Substance Use ☐ All Health Topics

#HSCert healthyschools@ophea.net 1

healthyschools.ca

Healthy Schools Certification Summary Report: Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board

2023 - 2024

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic DSB

Certified Healthy Schools

STUDENTS REACHED
25,153

SCHOOLS REACHED
45
(36 Gold, 4 Silver, 5 Bronze)

GRADES
Elementary - 80%
Secondary - 18%
Adult/Continuing Ed. - 2%



Gold

- Annunciation of Our Lord Elementary School
- Bishop Ryan Catholic Secondary School
- Bishop Tonnos Catholic Secondary School
- Canadian Martyrs Elementary School
- Cathedral High School
- Corpus Christi Elementary School
- Our Lady of Hope Catholic Elementary School
- Our Lady of Mount Carmel Elementary School
- Our Lady of Peace Catholic Elementary School
- Pope John Paul II Elementary School
- Sacred Heart Elementary School
- St Francis Xavier Catholic Elementary School
- St Matthew Catholic Elementary School (Binbrook)
- St. Agnes Elementary School
- St. Ann Elementary School (Hamilton)
- St. Clare of Assisi Elementary School
- St. David Elementary School
- St. Eugene Elementary School
- St. Jean de Brebeuf Catholic Secondary School
- St. John Henry Newman Catholic Secondary School
- St. Joseph Elementary School
- St. Kateri Tekakwitha Catholic Elementary School
- St. Lawrence Elementary School
- St. Luke Elementary School
- St. Margaret Mary Elementary School
- St. Marguerite d'Youville Elementary School
- St. Mark Elementary School
- St. Martin of Tours Elementary School
- St. Mary's Catholic Secondary School
- St. Michael Elementary School
- St. Patrick Elementary School
- St. Paul Elementary School
- St. Therese of Lisieux Catholic Elementary School
- St. Thomas Elementary School
- Sts. Peter and Paul Catholic Elementary School
- Wilma's Place

Silver

- Holy Name of Jesus Elementary School
- Immaculate Conception Elementary School
- St. Anthony Daniel Catholic Elementary School
- St. Vincent de Paul Elementary School

Bronze

- Our Lady of the Assumption Catholic Elementary School
- St. Charles Adult & Continuing Education
- St. Gabriel Catholic Elementary School
- St. Joachim Elementary School
- St. John the Baptist Elementary School

#HSCert

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic DSB

PRIORITY HEALTH TOPICS

Each school selected up to three health topics based on their assets and priorities:

Mental Health	→	**91%**
Physical Activity	→	**77%**
Healthy Eating	→	**49%**
Growth & Development	→	**8%**
Substance Use	→	**2%**
Injury Prevention	→	**4%**

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic DSB

SCHOOL ACTIVITIES

HWCDSB schools implemented a variety of programs and activities to support health and well-being in their schools!

Mental Health

- Sticky Notes Campaign - Positive Affirmations
- Cocoa and Cram; Mental Health Week
- Orange Shirt Day - National Day for Truth & Reconciliation
- Mental Wellness Day
- Bell Let's Talk
- Walk for Wenjack
- Brain Break
- CMHA Presentation
- Calming Colouring
- Lift Each Other Up
- B.T. Movie Night
- Bully Prevention and Awareness
- I am the I in Kind
- Choose Kindness Mural
- Chill Fair
- Intermediate Mental Health Literacy Lesson Plans
- Pink Shirt Day
- Talent Show

Healthy Eating

- Eat the Rainbow
- The Great Big Crunch
- Taste Buds Nutrition Program
- Great Big Crunch
- Making a Fruit Salad
- Bring Back Breakfast

Physical Activity / Injury Prevention

- LEAD Recess Program
- Concussion Talks
- Co-operative Game Drop-In
- Intramurals
- Winter Holiday Party
- Fall Walking Challenge
- Recess Guardians
- Cross-Country and Track & Field
- Swim Team
- Fair Play for all - Inclusive Play
- Board-Wide Invitational Soccer Tournament

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic DSB

COMMUNITY PARTNERS

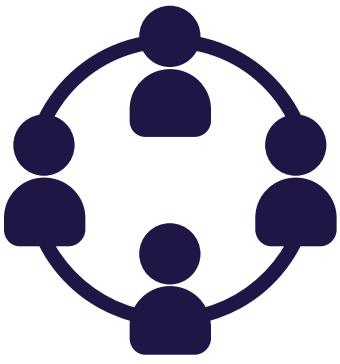
Community partnerships were vital to support HWCDSB's healthy schools during the 2023/24 school year!

- Tastebuds Hamilton
- Rising Stars
- Public Health Nurse
- City of Hamilton's Public Health Department
- LEAD/Active Recess
- Niwasa/NYA (Indigenous Youth Advisor)
- Municipality of Hamilton
- First Nations, Metis, Inuit (FNMI) Leaders
- CMHA (Canadian Mental Health Association)
- Recess Guardians
- Empowerment Squared
- Tim Hortons
- First Ontario Credit Union
- The Ontario Produce Marketing Association
- Drummond Farms
- Big Brother/Big Sister Organization

SCHOOL COLLABORATION

HWCDSB collaborated with other teams within their schools and made use of the HSC program to address Student Engagement and Wellbeing!

- 88% reported including the Healthy Schools Certification program as an action to address the priorities in the Student Engagement & Well-Being area of focus on the School Improvement Plan/Student Achievement Plan.



- 47% reported that their HSC/HAT Teams collaborated with other school teams. Examples include:
  - Student Council
  - Eco Team
  - Mental Health Team
  - St. Mark through CYW
  - Peer mentors
  - Chaplaincy Teams
  - Leadership Team
  - Peer mentors

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic DSB

PROGRAM OUTCOMES

HWCDSB educators completed a year-end survey to share their experiences with the Healthy Schools Certification program - here's what they had to say:

Impact on Student Health and Well-Being

- 100% reported HSC positively impacting student health and well-being.

School Experience

- 82% reported HS Certification as Excellent/Very Good in supporting schools to prioritize health and wellness (4-point scale).

School Successes

- 89% reported greater focus on health and wellness in their school
- 83% reported increased student engagement
- 44% reported increased community partnerships
- 44% reported improved student health outcomes
- 44% reported increased staff engagement
- 33% reported increased administrator support
- 67% reported improved inclusive school environment
- 72% reported increased sense of student belonging

School Challenges

- 61% reported time as challenge to implement HS Certification program
- 22% lack of financial resources
- 33% reported lack of staff support
- 22% lack of community partners

School Sustainability

- 94% reported intent to re-register for HS Certification for 2024/25 school year (6% reported 'maybe').

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic DSB

PROGRAM OUTCOMES

HWCDSB educators completed a year-end survey to share their experiences with the Healthy Schools Certification program - here's what they had to say:

Faith-Based Activities

- 82% reported incorporating faith-based activities in their school's action plan. Activities include:
  - Christian Meditation
  - Beginning activities with a prayer
  - Food and clothing drives
  - Philosophy of "Each Belongs" considered in activity planning
  - Stewards of the Earth
  - Liturgies/Advent Night
  - Rosary club, prayer club

School Improvement and Equity Plan

- 87% reported including the HS Certification process to support a health and well-being goal on their School Improvement and Equity Plan

REPORT **SAWB-24-8**

TO: **STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING COMMITTEE**

SUBJECT: **ENGLISH AS A SECOND LANGUAGE AND NEWCOMER UPDATE: ELEMENTARY**

DATE: **TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024**

2024-25 BUDGET DRIVER ALIGNMENT

Excellence: Improve student literacy learning and achievement

ORIGIN

Director's Council

BACKGROUND

The Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board (HWCDSB) is committed to prioritizing and respecting the dignity of each person and fosters a supportive Catholic school community environment that welcomes and supports English Language Learners (ELL) and all newcomers to Canada. Students are supported in faith formation, building positive relationships, and contributing to the good of society.

This report highlights the HWCDSB ELL enrollment and newcomers to Canada statistics for the 2023/24 school year and Fall 2024.

COMMENT

English Language Learners may require focussed educational supports to assist in attaining proficiency in the English language and may be Canadian born or recently arrived from other countries.

Newcomers to Canada are students who come from diverse backgrounds and school experiences, were born outside of Canada, and may or may not have English as their first language.

The Ministry of Education document, Supporting English Language Learners: A Practical Guide for Ontario Educators, (2008) outlines two programs:

1) English as a Second Language programs are for students whose first language is other than English or is a variety of English significantly different from that used for instruction in Ontario schools. Students in these programs have had educational opportunities to develop age-appropriate first-language literacy skills.

2) English Literacy Development programs are for students whose first language is other than English or is a variety of English significantly different from that used for

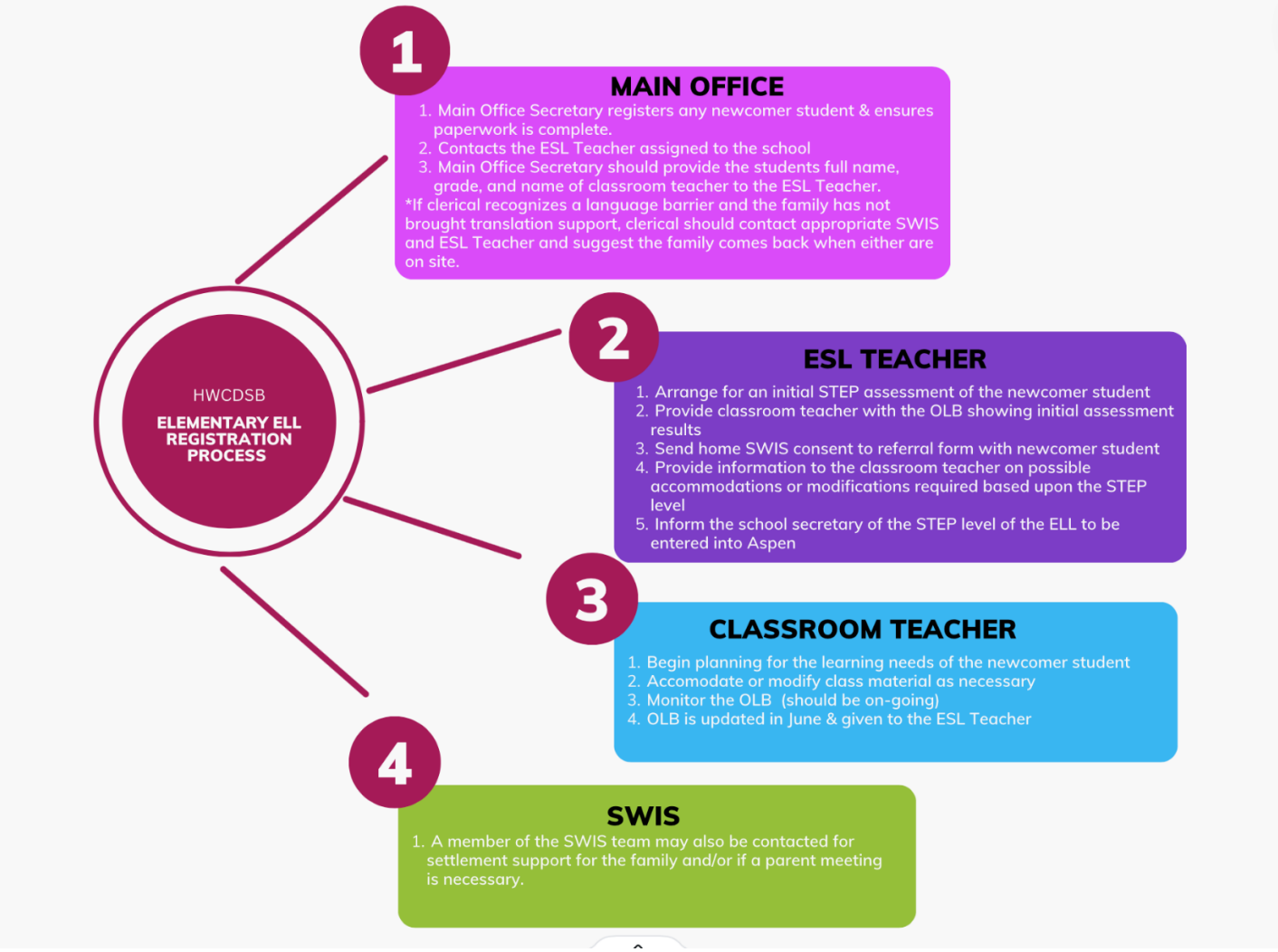
instruction in Ontario schools. Students in these programs are most often from countries in which access to education has been limited, and there are limited opportunities to develop language and literacy skills in any language. Schooling in their countries of origin has been inconsistent, disrupted, or even completely unavailable throughout the years that the children would otherwise have been in school. As a result, the children arrive in Ontario schools with significant gaps in education.

The Ministry of Education document, Steps To English Proficiency (STEP) A Guide for Users, (2015) stipulates that Ontario schools use the STEP framework to assess and monitor the language acquisition and literacy development of ELLs across the Ontario Curriculum. The STEP resource includes:

- oral, reading and writing continua, to support students requiring English as a Second Language (ESL) program;
- a continua of English language proficiency as well as literacy skills for students requiring an English Literacy Development (ELD) program;
- resources to guide instruction and classroom-based assessment; and,
- the STEP assessment process for initial and ongoing assessment.

ELL and Newcomer Registration Protocol: Elementary Panel

The following is the process that is followed for newcomers and ELL students registering in elementary schools.



STEP Initial Assessment

Upon arrival, elementary newcomer ELLs complete an initial assessment administered by the ESL elementary teachers. The initial assessment is a major component of the registration process of new students and includes: reading comprehension, student writing, oral communication, mathematical knowledge and skills. These assessments are compared to six levels that reflect progress from a beginner level (STEP 1) towards proficiency (STEP 6). This initial assessment will result in a STEP level and will assist educators in placement and programming as well as monitoring and reporting.

Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4	Step 5	Step 6
Modify and Accommodate *(require ESL programming)*	**Modify and Accommodate *(require ESL programming)***	**Modify and Accommodate *(may require ESL programming)***	**Accommodate**	**On Grade Accommodate**	**On Grade**

More information about the support model for STEP designations can be found in Appendix A.

Role of the ESL Teacher

Elementary ESL teachers visit their assigned schools to conduct initial assessments and parent/SWIS meetings if required**.** Once assessed, newcomer STEP designations are shared with appropriate personnel and STEP designations are added to ASPEN for each ELL student. All Kindergarten students remain unleveled until Grade 1 when literacy skills are assessed to determine appropriate STEP level. More information about the role of the ESL teacher can be found in Appendix B.

The ELL enrollment data is reviewed each year for the purposes of program monitoring and improvement. It highlights by term, first-language spoken at home, and countries of origin.

Data Sources:

The following are the data sources:

- Appendix A: ELL Support Model
- Appendix B: ESL Teacher Role Profile
- Appendix C: ESL Students New to Board by Year
- Appendix D: First Languages Reported Between July 1/23 to September 30/24
- Appendix E: Countries of Origin
- Appendix F: Birth Countries Outside of Canada 2023/24
- Appendix G: STEP Designations
- Appendix H: STEP 1 and 2 Designations by Postal Code

- Appendix I: SWIS Program Workers Language Support for School Meetings

Key Findings:

The following are the key findings:

- an 18.7% increase in the number of ESL students in 2023/24 compared to 2022/23;
- between July 1, 2024 and September 30, 2024, 80 new ESL students registered;
- students are being registered as newcomers and selecting English as their first-language (49% of registrations since July 1, 2023), however after registration and the STEP analysis, many of the students who have English listed as a first-language are captured as STEP 1 or 2 and are not proficient in English;
- Spanish continues to be the most frequent language spoken as a first language for ESL students, accounting for 33.5% of ELLs' language spoken at home;
- September 2024 marked the first time that Igbo and Yoruba are in the top five most frequent first languages for ESL students;
- the two top countries of origin are the Philippines and Nigeria;
- the upward trends in ESL new arrivals and the current intake for Fall 2024 reveal that elementary schools are on track to surpass last year's ELL population;
- positive trajectory suggests potential growth in overall enrollment, emphasizing the need for proactive planning to accommodate the increasing ELL population;
- Fall 2024 ELL enrollment data reflects the increased enrollment of ELLs with STEP designations 1 and 2 (students with limited to no English);
- during 2023/24 a total of 1793 students were counted in the STEP designation and in the Fall 2024, the total increased by 284 students for a total of 2077;
- the following STEPs had an increase in ELLs in Fall 2024 from 2023/24:
  - STEP 1: 8% (+23 students)
  - STEP 2: 39% (+59 students)
  - STEP 3: 20% (+47 students)
  - STEP 6: 23% (+223 students)
- the following STEPs had a decrease in Fall 2024 from 2023/24:
  - STEP 4: 23% (-44 students)
  - STEP 5: 12% (-21 students)

Prior to the 2022/23 school year, STEP three ELLs received a 40-minute period of direct support. Due to the increase in caseloads, ESL now focus on priority students which includes all ELD, STEP 1 and 2 ELLs. More information the support model is contained in Appendix A.

Next Steps:

As the number of ELL students continues to increase annually, it is recommended that the following be considered:

- a review of the current intervention model to determine if it is meeting the needs of the ELL learners;

- an in-depth analysis of comparable school boards' successful practices for supporting ELL students and newcomers to Canada;
- an analysis to examine how students are being registered as newcomers including which first-language is selected to ensure that students are being properly captured and identified; and,
- continue to build the relationship with the Settlement Workers in Schools (SWIS).

RECOMMENDATION

THAT THE REPORT, ENGLISH AS A SECOND LANGUAGE AND NEWCOMER UPDATE: ELEMENTARY, DATED TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024, BE RECEIVED.

PREPARED BY: A. COLETTO
ACTING ASSISTANT SUPERINTENDENT OF EDUCATION

SUBMITTED BY: D. HANSEN
DIRECTOR OF EDUCATION

APPENDIX A

ELL SUPPORT MODEL

STEP Designation	Weekly and Ongoing Support
ELD (*students with limited or no prior schooling)*	-receive two (2), 40-minute periods of direct support per week -ESL elementary Teachers provide direct support to teachers AND student monitoring
STEP 1 (*limited to no English proficiency)*	-receive two (2), 40-minute periods of direct support per week -ESL elementary Teachers provide direct support to teachers AND student monitoring
STEP 2 (*limited to no English proficiency)*	-receive one (1), 40-minute period of direct support per week -ESL elementary Teachers provide direct support to teachers AND student monitoring
STEPs 3-6 Students	-do not receive ESL direct support -ESL elementary Teachers provide direct support to teachers AND student monitoring

** HWCDSB has a complement of **12.5 FTE** ESL elementary teachers*

APPENDIX B

ESL TEACHER ROLE PROFILE

- support the ELLs and their families, together with the YMCA Settlement Workers in Schools (SWIS) during registration, settlement and in-take meetings with administration (e.g., review of School Messenger, collection of uniforms, transportation, etc.);
- conduct initial STEP assessments for each newcomer (approx. 2 hours);
- provide weekly, direct support to ELD, STEP 1 and STEP 2 students;
- provide ongoing direct support to teachers;
- provide ongoing student monitoring;
- update Observable Language Behaviours (OLBs) STEP levels throughout the year (mandated by The Ministry of Education to be completed annually) to be updated in ASPEN and hardcopy to be filed in OSR by the ESL teacher;
- support pathway planning, timetabling;
- coordinate communication with parents, school staff, and community partners;
- maintain a close working relationship with SWIS workers; and,
- assist in Grade 8 transition meetings.

APPENDIX C

ESL STUDENTS NEW TO BOARD BY YEAR

HWCDSB Elementary ESL Students New to Board by Year	
Date	**Total**
2021-22	**344**
2022-23	**439 (21.6% increase over previous year)**
2023-24	**540 (18.7% increase over previous year)**
Fall 2024*	**80***

Between July 1, 2024 and September 30, 2024, 80 new ELL students have registered in elementary school.

APPENDIX D

FIRST-LANGUAGES REPORTED BETWEEN JULY 1/23 to SEPTEMBER 30/24

Between July 1, 2023, and September 30, 2024, a total of 608 students registered as newcomers from outside of Canada. Of the 608 registered students, 313 selected a first-language other than English. A total of 32 languages other than English were selected as a first-language.

	Top Five Languages in HWCDSB Elementary Schools		
	2022-23	**2023-24**	**Fall 2024**
1	Spanish	Spanish	Spanish (33.5%)*
2	Ukrainian	Tagalog	Tagalog (12.5%)*
3	Portuguese	Filipino	Igbo (8.3%)*
4	Tagalog	Ukrainian	Ukrainian (7.7%)*
5	Arabic	Portuguese	Yoruba (5.8%)*

the other 32.2% is made up of 26 other first-languages as listed below

First Language	Percentage	First Language	Percentage
Portuguese	4.8%	Russian	1.0%
Malayalam	2.9%	Swahili	1.0%
Arabic	2.2%	Cebuano	0.6%
Assyrian	1.9%	Kinyarwanda	0.6%
Urdu	1.9%	Other	0.6%
Vietnamese	1.9%	Slovak	0.6%
Tigrinya	1.6%	Tamil	0.6%
German	1.3%	Thai	0.6%
Sinhala	1.3%	Turkish	0.6%
Afrikaans	1.0%	Croatian	0.3%
Creole	1.0%	Hiligaynon	0.3%
Edo	1.0%	Shona	0.3%
French	1.0%	Singhalese	0.3%
Hungarian	1.0%		

APPENDIX E

COUNTRIES OF ORIGIN

	Top Five Countries of Origin in HWCDSB Elementary Schools		
	2022-2023	**2023-2024**	**Fall 2024**
1	Nigeria	Nigeria	Philippines
2	Ukraine	Philippines	Nigeria
3	Columbia	Mexico	Colombia
4	Mexico	Ukraine	Uganda
5	Philippines	Colombia	Venezuela

80 elementary students arrived from outside of Canada and registered for FDK to Grade 8 for September 2024.

Country of Origin for September 2024	Number of elementary students
Philippines	17
Nigeria	12
Colombia	6
Uganda	6
Venezuela	5
Chile	4
Germany	4
Mexico	3
USA	3
Bahamas	2
China	2
Ghana	2
Haiti	2
Hungary	2
India	2
Singapore	2
South Africa	2
Israel	1
Jamaica	1
Malaysia	1
United Arab Emirates	1
TOTAL	**80**

APPENDIX F

BIRTH COUNTRIES OUTSIDE OF CANADA 2023/24

Between July 1, 2023 to June 30, 2024 (previous school year), a total of 540 students enrolled at HWCDSB elementary schools who were born outside of Canada.

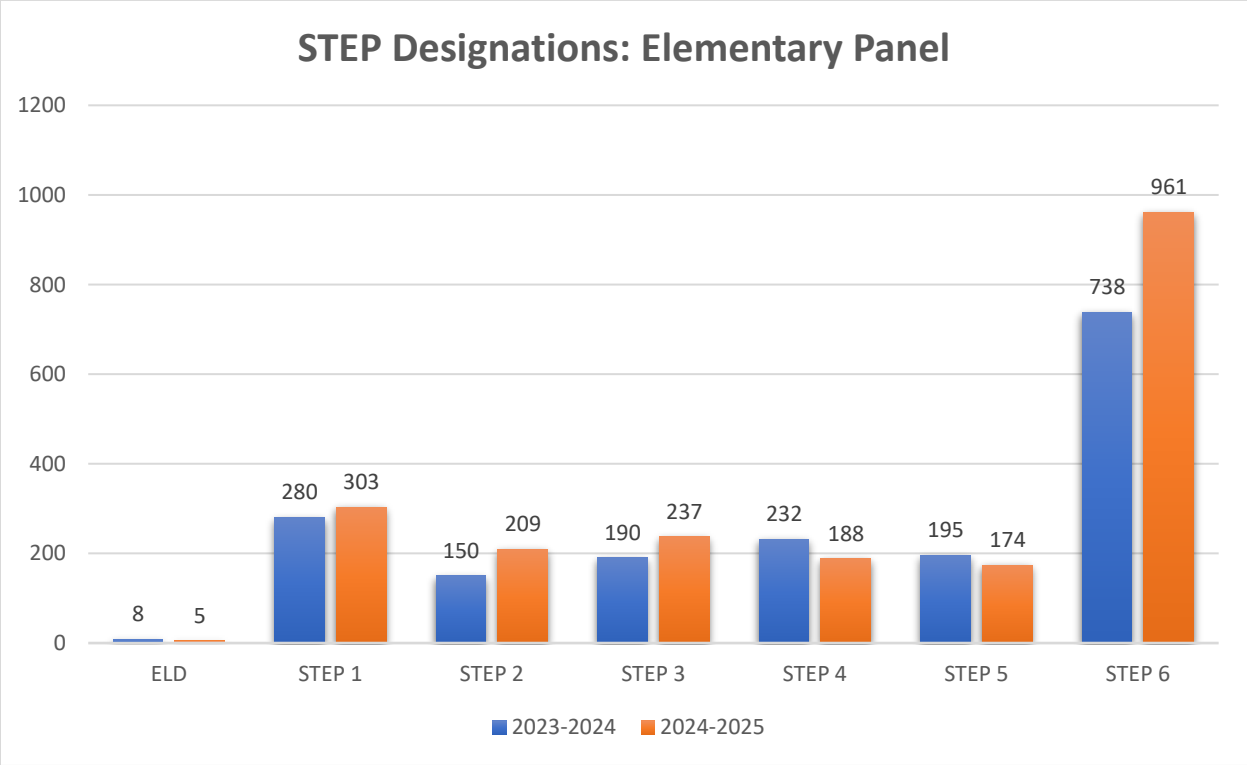
Birth Country	Number of elementary students	Birth Country	Number of elementary students	Birth Country	Number of elementary students
Nigeria	192	El Salvador	4	Sudan	2
Philippines	57	Portugal	4	Uganda	2
Mexico	43	United Arab Emirates	4	Belgium	1
Ukraine	32	United Kingdom	4	Croatia	1
Colombia	30	Chile	3	France	1
USA	19	Ghana	3	Haiti	1
Brazil	11	Jamaica	3	India	1
Dominican Republic	8	Rwanda	3	Kuwait	1
India	8	Syria	3	Malaysia	1
Ecuador	7	Turkey	3	Nicaragua	1
Iraq	7	Argentina	2	Qatar	1
Pakistan	7	Bahamas	2	Russia	1
South Africa	7	Barbados	2	Singapore	1
Vietnam	7	Eritrea	2	Thailand	1
Cameroon	6	Georgia	2	United States	1
Cuba	6	Guinea	2	Zimbabwe	1
Sri Lanka	6	Ireland	2		
Kenya	5	Japan	2		
Peru	5	Lebanon	2		
Saudi Arabia	5	Slovakia	2		

APPENDIX G

STEP DESIGNATIONS

STEP Designation	2023-2024	STEP Designations as of September 30, 2024	Year over year comparison
ELD	8	5	38% decrease
STEP 1	280	303	8% increase
STEP 2	150	209	39% increase
STEP 3	190	237	20% increase
STEP 4	232	188	23% decrease
STEP 5	195	174	12% decrease
STEP 6	738	961	23% increase
TOTAL	**1793**	**2077**	**14% increase**

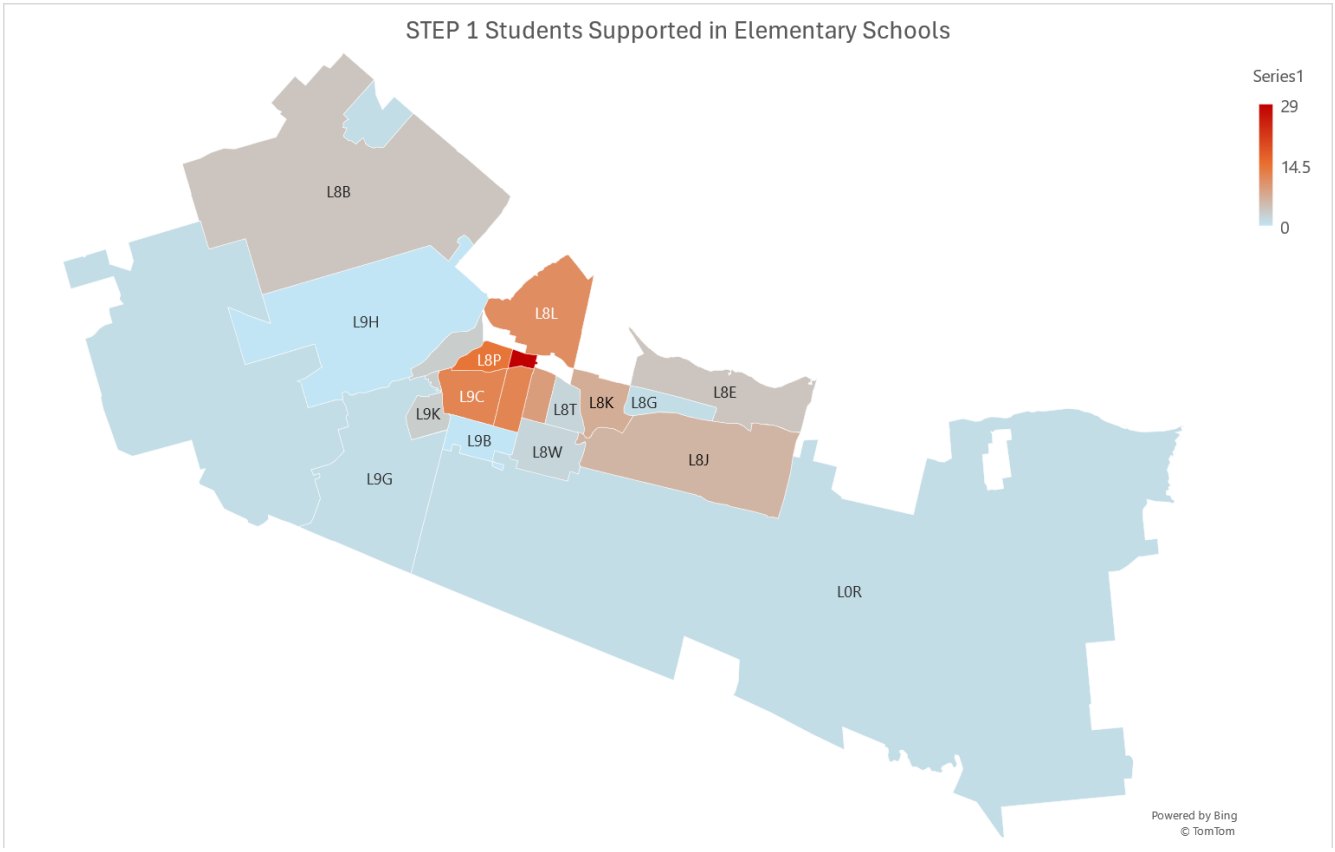
ELD, STEP 1 and 2 students are supported directly by ESL teachers (see Appendix A).

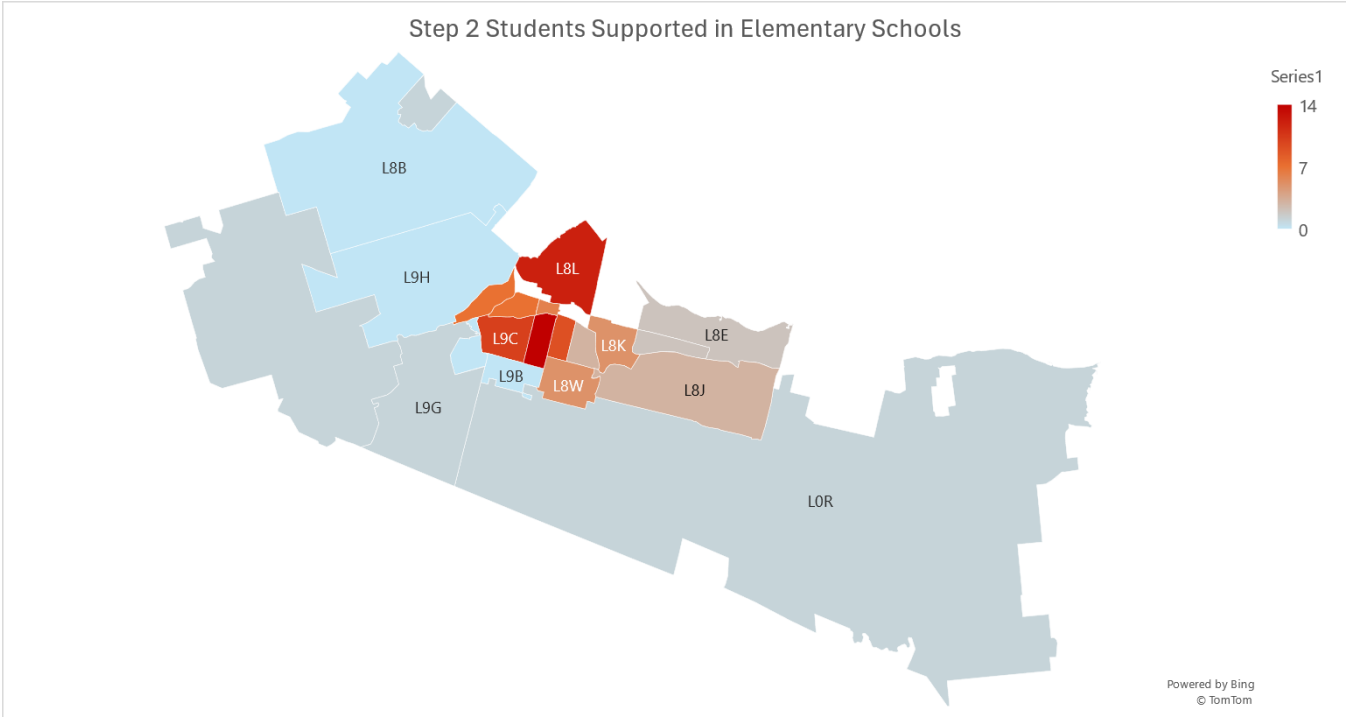


APPENDIX H

STEP 1 and 2 DESIGNATIONS BY POSTAL CODE

(AS SUPPORTED BY ESL TEACHERS)





APPENDIX I

SWIS PROGRAM WORKERS LANGUAGE SUPPORT FOR SCHOOL MEETINGS

Type of Meeting	SWIS Staff Provide Language and Settlement Support	SWIS Staff Attend in the Capacity of a Settlement Worker (no interpretation)
School Registration		
Parent Teacher Meetings/Interviews		
School communication regarding academics/behavior at school		
Individual Education Plan Meeting (IEP)		
Catholic School Council Meetings (newcomers)		
Group Information/Workshop sessions in partnership with the schools		
School open house events		
Meetings with School Administration, School Staff (ESL Teachers, Learning Resource Teachers, Guidance Counselors) to facilitate communication		
Identification Placement Review Committee (IPRC) Meetings		
Meetings/Communication with youth/parents regarding academic, attendance or behavioral concerns at school		
Meetings with School Administrators (behavioral/attendance/suspensions/expulsions)		
Meetings with School Administrators & Police Officers for legal matters		
Pathways to Education Registration/Intake Meetings		
Pathways to Education (follow-up meetings)		
Meeting with Social Worker (school related matters; attendance, behavior)		
Meeting with Social Worker (external domestic/personal matters)		
Transportation Office (courtesy/school bus)		

***Green**- Language Support Offered*

***Red**- Language Support Not Offered*

REPORT **SAWB-24-8**

TO: **STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING**

SUBJECT: **SUSPENSION, EXPULSION, REFUSAL OF ACCESS, AND VIOLENT INCIDENT REPORT 2023/24**

DATE: **TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024**

2024-25 BUDGET DRIVER ALIGNMENT

Student and Staff Mental Health and Well-Being

ORIGIN

Director's Council

BACKGROUND

The Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board (HWCDSB) collects student suspension, expulsion, refusal of access, and violent incident data. This information is analyzed to identify trends and determine responses to ensure student behaviour reflects a Catholic school environment. Information in this report is aggregate board data. School specific data is shared with schools to identify areas of focus to decrease incidents, provide intervention and supports, and to ensure that students experience healthy, safe, receptive, and Christ-centred learning environments. The information is to be used with other school-based data such as the Catholic School Climate Survey, anti-bullying school reports, attendance data, etc. The HWCDSB also provides the aggregate board data in its annual report to the Ministry of Education.

This report outlines the total number of suspension and expulsions, in various categories, for the 2023/24 school year as compared to the 2022/23 school year. Also included is information on the number of violent incidents and refusal of access reports.

COMMENT

Suspension and expulsion data is reviewed regularly to ensure consistency, accountability, and examine trends. Board data is shared with principals to highlight board specific trends and for their own school comparison in the various categories.

The statistical information provided in this report presents a synopsis that reflects the 2023/24 school year (Appendix A). Data is also provided for the 2022/23 school year (Appendix B).

Data Source:

This report provides the following relevant data for the 2023/24 school year:

- suspension and expulsion (HWCDSB Aspen database); and,

- Participation in the HWCDSB long term suspension program, Program to Assist Student Success (PASS); and the HWCDSB expulsion program, Student Opportunity to Achieve Re-entry (SOAR).

The following charts outline a summary of suspension information for 2023/24 and 2022/23 school year:

Key Findings:

2023/2024

School Panel	Male Students	Female Students	Total # Students Suspended at Least Once	Total # of Students Suspended More than Once	Total # Suspensions
Elementary	298	52	350	74	474
Secondary	540	257	797	239	1,249
Grand Total	**838**	**309**	**1,147**	**313**	**1,723**

2022/2023

School Panel	Male Students	Female Students	Total # Students Suspended at Least Once	Total # of Students Suspended More than Once	Total # Suspensions
Elementary	244	65	309	60	387
Secondary	490	270	760	217	1,143
Grand Total	**734**	**335**	**1,069**	**277**	**1,530**

There has been an overall increase in the number of suspensions in the 2023/24 school year as well as the total number of students suspended more than once. However, there is a decrease of suspensions for students with an exceptionality.

Data from the 2023/24 school year:

- Total number of students suspended: 1,147
  [320 of whom have an exceptionality or an individual Education Plan (IEP)].
- Total number of suspensions: 1,723
- Total number of suspension infractions: 2,156.
  A student may have more than one infraction per suspension.
- Total number of distinct infractions: 331
  In cases where a student is suspended multiple times for the same infraction, the infraction is counted only once.
- Students suspended more than once: 313

Data from the 2022/23 school year:

- Total number of students suspended: 1,069
  [441 of whom have an exceptionality or an individual Education Plan (IEP)].
- Total number of suspensions: 1,530
- Total number of suspension infractions: 1,758
  A student may have more than one infraction per suspension.
- Total number of distinct infractions: 286
  In cases where a student is suspended multiple times for the same infraction, the infraction is counted only once.
- Students suspended more than once: 277

The appendices contain the following information:

- Appendix A provides a summary of various data points for the 2023/24 school year, including grade levels and gender.
- Appendix B provides the same information for the 2022/23 school year.
- Appendix C shows the total number of suspensions in elementary and secondary schools for the years 2021/22 to 2023/24.
- Appendix D provides a summary of suspension infractions. The information includes findings both for all students and for students with an exceptionality for the 2023/24 school year.
- Appendix E provides the same information for the 2022/23 school year.
- Appendix F is a legend that explains the HWCDSB suspension codes.

In 2023/24, 17 students were expelled from the HWCDSB. Of the 17 students, 1 student received a school-based expulsion and 16 received board-based expulsions. In the 2022/23 school year, there were 11 students expelled from the HWCDSB. Four received school-based expulsions, and seven received board-based expulsion.

The Program to Assist Student Success (PASS) for suspended students addresses the education and behavior improvement in an alternative setting for students on suspension between 6-20 days. For the 2023/24 school year, 90 students accessed PASS, nine were elementary school students and 81 were secondary school students. In the 2022/23 school year, 52 students accessed the program. This program provides academic and non-academic support to assist students in making the transition back to mainstream school through an individualized re-entry plan.

Refusal of Access

In the 2023/24 school year there were a total of 10 students excluded and in the 2022/23 school year there were a total of 13 students excluded.

Violent Incidents
In the 2023/24 school year there were a total of 42 students involved in violent incidents and in the 2022/23 school year there were a total of 25 students involved in violent incidents.

Next Steps:
- Ongoing professional development for principals and vice principals on new legislation, including updates to Policy/Program Memorandum (PPM) No. 128 – Provincial Code of Conduct and School Board Codes of Conduct.
- Professional development with the Child and Youth Workers on vaping prevention, in collaboration with Hamilton Public Health.
- Professional development of school staff to support prevention and early intervention practices, including application of progressive discipline, social-emotional learning, HWCDSB supported programs including but not limited to Restorative Practices, Zones of Regulation, Tools for Life, and school engagement initiatives (e.g., customized schedules).
- Utilization of HWCDSB staff with expertise in counselling, mentorship, community engagement, prevention strategies, student self-regulation, and recidivism prevention, both board and school based, e.g., Graduation Coach for Black Students, School Social Worker, Child and Youth Workers, Applied Behaviour Analysts, Behaviour Educational Assistants.
- Application of HWCDSB programs that foster collaboration with families, e.g. Triple P, Emotion Focussed Family Therapy. This program has received favourable reviews from both families who have engaged in the learning, as well as from school administrators.
- Regular review of suspension/expulsion data with school administrators, including demographic data where possible and Catholic School Climate Survey results to identify areas of focus.
- A committee has been established to review, discern, and compare the data in relation to PPM 120, 145 and Health and Safety legislation.
- Continued professional development and the implementation of the Grades 7 and 8 Mental Health Literacy Learning Modules.
- Professional development and the implementation of the revised Grade 10 Careers curricula with specific focus on new expectations and new mental health expectations.
- HWCDSB representation on community committees and partnerships to address high risk behaviors.
- In collaboration with families, use of community partners in proactively addressing behaviours which could lead to suspensions or expulsions (e.g., diversion programs).

RECOMMENDATION

THAT THE REPORT, SUSPENSION, EXPULSION, REFUSAL OF ACCESS, AND VIOLENT INCIDENT REPORT 2023/24, DATED TUESDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2024, BE RECEIVED.

PREPARED BY: J. ATHANASIOU-MALISA
SENIOR MANAGER OF STUDENT MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORTS AND SERVICE/CHIEF ATTENDANCE COUNSELLOR

SUBMITTED BY: T. KOVACH
SUPERINTENDENT OF EDUCATION

D. HANSEN
DIRECTOR OF EDUCATION

HWCDSB Suspension Data 2023-2024 (all students)

Students Suspended

Students Suspended (individual distinct students)	Males												Females												Total Students Suspended
	Elementary								Secondary				Elementary								Secondary				
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade	0	0	2	26	41	37	104	88	169	130	121	120	0	0	0	3	4	11	10	24	87	63	59	48	1,147
Total By Division	298								540				52								257				
Total By Gender	838												309												

Note: Student only counted once even if they have more than one suspension

Total Incidents

Note: Total number of all suspensions, e.g., 1 fight; 3 students; 3 suspensions (i.e., 3 incidents)

Total Number of Suspensions (Students may be suspended more than once; not a discrete student count)	Males												Females												Total Incidents
	Elementary								Secondary				Elementary								Secondary				
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade	0	0	3	33	68	51	134	124	303	243	186	161	0	0	0	3	5	13	10	30	129	93	80	54	1,723
Total By Division	413								893				61								356				
Total By Gender	1,306												417												

Incident Infractions

Incident Infractions	Males												Females												Total Incident Infractions
All Infractions (Codes used in the suspensions)	Elementary								Secondary				Elementary								Secondary				
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade	0	0	4	36	96	76	182	165	368	300	223	188	0	0	0	3	5	18	12	37	157	117	102	67	2,156
Total By Division	559								1,079				75								443				
Total By Gender	1,638												518												

Note: Infraction (code) count for all suspensions, e.g., 1 suspension with 2 codes (fighting and bullying)

Note: Does not indicate how many students involved

APPENDIX A

Distinct Infractions

Distinct Infractions	Males												Females												Total Distinct Infractions
	Elementary								Secondary				Elementary								Secondary				
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade	0	0	4	13	17	20	21	24	29	26	29	29	0	0	0	4	3	11	9	12	21	20	23	16	331
Total By Division	99								113				39								80				
Total By Gender	212												119												

Note: A student may have been suspended 3 times for bullying but counted only 1 time for bullying

Note: e.g., Gr. 8 males: 7 distinct students; 14 suspensions; 18 types of infractions (codes); 10 distinct codes

Students Suspended More Than Once

Students Suspended More than Once	Males												Females												Total Students Suspended More than Once
	Elementary								Secondary				Elementary								Secondary				
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade	0	0	1	6	14	8	16	21	58	56	39	27	0	0	0	0	1	2	0	5	22	17	15	5	313
Total By Division	66								180				8								59				
Total By Gender	246												67												

HWCDSB Suspension Data 2022-2023 (all students)

Students Suspended

Students Suspended (individual distinct students)	Males														Females														Total Students Suspended
	Elementary										Secondary				Elementary										Secondary				
	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade				1		25	22	52	69	75	149	109	116	116						3	10	8	26	18	81	85	60	44	1,069
Total By Division	244										490				65										270				
Total By Gender	734														335														

Note: Student only counted once even if they have more than one suspension

Total Incidents

Total Incidents (Total number of suspensions; students may be suspended more than once; not a discrete student count)	Males														Females														Total Incidents
	Elementary										Secondary				Elementary										Secondary				
	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade				1		28	31	65	92	90	242	184	177	145						3	11	9	35	22	134	123	83	55	1,530
Total By Division	307										748				80										395				
Total By Gender	1,055														475														

Note: Total number of all suspensions, e.g., 1 fight; 3 students; 3 suspensions (i.e., 3 incidents)

Incident Infractions

Incident Infractions	Males														Females														Total Incident Infractions
All Infractions	Elementary										Secondary				Elementary										Secondary				
(Codes used in the suspensions)	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade				1		33	35	84	124	110	272	202	194	165						3	13	11	52	29	147	133	88	62	1,758
Total By Division	387										833				108										430				
Total By Gender	1,220														538														

Note: Infraction (code) count for all suspensions, e.g., 1 suspension with 2 codes (fighting and bullying)
Note: Does not indicate how many students involved

Distinct Infractions

Distinct Infractions	Males														Females														Total Distinct Infractions
	Elementary										Secondary				Elementary										Secondary				
	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade				1		10	8	15	18	15	21	27	24	24						2	9	5	16	13	22	20	17	19	286
Total By Division	67										96				45										78				
Total By Gender	163														123														

Note: A student may have been suspended 3 times for bullying but counted only 1 time for bullying

Note: e.g., Gr. 8 males: 7 distinct students; 14 suspensions; 18 types of infractions (codes); 10 distinct codes

Students Suspended More Than Once

Students Suspended More than Once	Males														Females														Total Students Suspended More than Once
	Elementary										Secondary				Elementary										Secondary				
	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	JK	SK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
Total By Grade						3	7	11	14	13	55	36	40	20							1	1	7	3	26	19	14	7	
Total By Division	48										151				12										66				277
Total By Gender	199														78														

Suspension Yearly Comparison (2021/22 - 2023/24)

Year	Total Number of Suspensions	Individual Students Suspended	Total Number of Secondary Suspensions	Number of Male Secondary Suspensions	Number of Female Secondary Suspensions	Total Number of Elementary Suspensions	Number of Male Elementary Suspensions	Number of Female Elementary Suspensions	Exceptionality
2021/22	1323	906	677	438	239	229	181	48	247
2022/23	1530	1069	760	490	270	309	244	65	441
2023/24	1723	1530	797	540	257	350	298	52	320

APPENDIX D

Summary of Student Suspension Infractions 2023-2024

All Students	
Infraction	**Cnt**
Violence_B	402
InappBehav_B	247
Opposition_B	221
VapingSmoking_B	216
Harmfulact_B	178
SocialMedia_B	121
Neglect_B	116
Profanity_B	99
DiscrimLang_B	79
VerbalAbuse	51
Bullying	50
PossessCannabis	49
ThreatsInjury	38
SuspDisc	33
InfluenceCan	30
Theft_B	27
CodeConduct_B	25
PhysAssault	23
Possess Weapon	19
InapprImages_B	14
DrugParaph_B	13
Motivated	13
PatternBehave	13
PosAlcDrugs	13
SeriousViolation	12
WillDestruct_B	10
UnacceptRisk	8
UseAlcohol	8
UseofWeapons	6
Vandalism	5
SeriousSingleAct	4
SexualAssault	4
SellCigVape_B	2
SuspMand	2
MinorAlcohol	1
Risk to Others	1
Robbery	1

Students with Exceptionality or IEP	
Infraction	**Cnt**
Violence_B	134
Opposition_B	103
InappBehav_B	80
Harmfulact_B	71
VapingSmoking_B	59
Profanity_B	49
Neglect_B	48
SocialMedia_B	32
VerbalAbuse	31
DiscrimLang_B	27
ThreatsInjury	24
Bullying	15
Theft_B	13
PossessCannabis	12
SuspDisc	10
Possess Weapon	9
CodeConduct_B	8
InfluenceCan	7
Motivated	7
SeriousViolation	7
PatternBehave	5
PosAlcDrugs	5
UnacceptRisk	4
WillDestruct_B	4
InapprImages_B	3
PhysAssault	3
DrugParaph_B	2
SeriousSingleAct	2
Vandalism	2
SuspMand	1
UseAlcohol	1
UseofWeapons	1

APPENDIX E

Summary of Student Suspension Infractions 2022-2023

All Students	
Infraction	**Cnt**
Violence_B	329
InappBehav_B	185
VapingSmoking_B	181
Opposition_B	179
Harmfulact_B	159
SocialMedia_B	94
Neglect_B	90
Profanity_B	77
Bullying	64
SeriousViolation	44
SuspDisc	39
ThreatsInjury	37
Theft_B	35
DiscrimLang_B	33
PossessCannabis	25
VerbalAbuse	25
CodeConduct_B	23
Possess Weapon	21
Motivated	17
InfluenceCan	13
PatternBehave	13
SuspMand	9
Vandalism	9
PosAlcDrugs	8
UseAlcohol	8
DrugParaph_B	6
PhysAssault	6
UnacceptRisk	6
UseofWeapons	6
WillDestruct_B	5
Risk to Others	4
InapprImages_B	3
SellCigVape_B	2
Robbery	1
Traffick	1
TraffickCannabis	1

Students with an Exceptionality or IEP	
Infraction	**Cnt**
Violence_B	48
Opposition_B	38
Harmfulact_B	33
VapingSmoking_B	26
Profanity_B	20
InappBehav_B	19
Neglect_B	17
Possess Weapon	14
Bullying	13
SocialMedia_B	12
PatternBehave	10
ThreatsInjury	10
PossessCannabis	9
Motivated	6
SignifMoral	6
SeriousViolation	5
CodeConduct_B	4
PhysAssault	4
SuspMand	4
Theft_B	4
UseofWeapons	4
Vandalism	4
DrugParaph_B	3
InfluenceCan	3
SuspDisc	3
PosAlcDrugs	2
SerViolateBrdCod	2
VerbalAbuse	2
ExtPropDamage	1
InapprImages_B	1
Risk to Others	1
Violence_B	48
Opposition_B	38
Harmfulact_B	33
VapingSmoking_B	26

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board
Believing, Achieving, Serving

HWCDSB SUSPENSION CODES

LEGEND

APPENDIX F

Revised March 2022

Incident Type Name	Full Description
Bullying	Bullying
CannabisToMinor	Giving cannabis to a minor
CodeConduct_B	Code of conduct, board & school policy
DiscrimLang_B	Using racist and/or discriminatory terms, language or name calling
DrugParaph_B	Possession of drug paraphernalia, board & school policy
Harmfulact_B	Committing and act harmful to the physical or mental well-being, board & school policy
IllDrugsMinor	Giving illegal or controlled drugs to a minor
InappBehav_B	Inappropriate Behaviour, board & school policy
InapprImages_B	Possession/Sharing of inappropriate images, board & school policy
InfluenceCan	Being under the influence of cannabis, unless the pupil is a medical cannabis user
MinorAlcohol	Giving alcohol to a minor
Motivated	Any activity listed in subsection 306 (1) that is motivated by bias, prejudice or hate based on race, national or ethnic origin, language, colour, religion, sex, age, mental or physical disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, or any other similar factor
Neglect_B	Habitual neglect of duty, board & school policy
Opposition_B	Opposition to Authority, board & school policy
PatternBehav	A pattern of behaviour that is so inappropriate that the student's continued presence is adjudged to be injurious to the effective learning and/ or working environment of others
PhysAssault	Committing physical assault on another person that causes bodily harm requiring treatment by a medical practitioner
PosAlcDrugs PossessWeapons	Possessing alcohol or illegal drugs (except cannabis) Possessing a weapon, including possessing a firearm
PossessCannabis	Possessing cannabis unless the pupil is a medical cannabis user
Profanity_B	Profanity/Swearing, board & school policy
Risk to Others	Bullying, if, i. the pupil has previously been suspended for engaging in bullying, and ii. the pupil's continuing presence in the school creates an unacceptable risk to the safety of another person.
Robbery	Committing robbery
SellCigVape_B	Selling cigarettes/vaping apparatus to minor, board & school policy
SeriousSingleAct	Where a Pupil has no history of discipline or behaviour intervention, a single act, incident or infraction considered by the Principal to be serious violation of HWCDSB Code of Conduct and Student Discipline
SeriousViolation	Any activity considered by the Principal to be a serious violation of the requirements for student behaviour and/ or a serious breach of the HWCDSB Code of Student Conduct and Discipline
SexualAssault	Committing sexual assault
SocialMedia_B	Using social media, the internet, and/or other virtual platforms negatively, board & school policy
SuspDisc	Any other activity that is an activity for which a principal may suspend a pupil under a policy of the board. 2007, c. 14, s. 4.

Hamilton-Wentworth Catholic District School Board
Believing, Achieving, Serving

STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT AND WELL-BEING COMMITTEE

UPCOMING SAWB REPORTS

NOVEMBER

1. Christian Service and Educational International Trips
2. Daily School Route (DSR) Update
3. Psych Services
4. ESL Update – Secondary
5. Graduation Coach for Black Students
6. Focus on Youth
7. Early Reading Screener Updates

DECEMBER

1. Arts Update K-12
2. Speech Language and Hearing
3. FLL Update
4. STEMley Cup
5. Mental Health and Anti-Bullying Update

Dear Father,

We thank You for guiding us and for the wisdom and insight shared today. As we conclude, we ask for Your continued blessing on our efforts and the efforts of administrators and presenters to support our students' success and well-being. May the presentations we've heard and the decisions we've made reflect Your love and serve the needs of our school community.

Grant us all the strength to carry out our work with compassion and dedication. Keep us united in purpose, always seeking to do Your will.

We ask this through Christ our Lord.

Amen.

